MEMO

To: Board of Education

From: Dr. Kimberlee Armstrong, Superintendent

Date: November 12, 2026

Subject: Superintendent's Rightsizing Schools Recommendation

While this has been a challenging month, what has been clear is how connected our students and families are to their schools. This recommendation is an important first step to stabilizing our schools across Portland Public Schools and providing students with rich learning environments regardless of where they live. We will need to regularly review how our resources are aligned with student needs. When we spread fewer resources across fewer schools we make a larger impact. We will develop an annual process to review enrollment across the system and determine if adjustments are needed. As part of the rightsizing process we established the Superintendent's Enrollment Advisory Committee made up of building principals and our union partners. This committee will become a standing committee to continue this process and as we move to the implementation phase. We will also monitor the following:

- Implementation of the changes approved by the board.
- Initiation of a systemwide review of middle schools in 2029-30.
- Initiation of a regional boundary review process, starting on the west side.

As part of my recommendation, I propose convening community advisory groups in each area where a school building is recommended for closure. Beginning as early as January, these groups will explore future building-use options and develop recommendations that reflect community priorities and needs.

Each group will forward me its recommendation, which I will bring to the Board at a future regular meeting for consideration.

My goal is to ensure that the future of these buildings is shaped by the communities they have served.

Executive Summary

Portland Public Schools faces declining enrollment and a $65 million budget deficit. Enrollment fell 12% between 2018-19 and 2025-26, with 89% of that decline in the elementary grades, and further losses are forecast to move into the middle grades next. Fewer students spread across the same number of buildings means more under-enrolled schools, thinner staffing and uneven access to programs. With no changes, fewer than 20% of PPS schools would have sustainable enrollment by 2031-32.

The Superintendent recommends closing and consolidating 10 elementary schools, phased over two years beginning in Fall 2027. The recommendation also:

- Converts seven K-8 schools to K-5, with grades 6-8 moving to nearby middle schools and one K-12 school to a K-8 with students moving to another alternative high school.
- Consolidates nine Spanish Dual Language Immersion (DLI) elementary pathways into four regional hubs and Mandarin DLI from three pathways to two.
- Changes school boundaries and feeder patterns to reflect the new configurations.

The recommendation substantially increases the number of students, and especially focal students, attending schools with enough enrollment to sustain stable, well-resourced programs.

Measure in 2031-32	Recommendation	Status quo / No change
K-5 schools above 360 students	50%	18%
Middle schools above 500 students	47%	13%
K-5 students experiencing poverty in sustainable schools	59%	20%
K-5 students receiving special education in sustainable schools	59%	21%
K-5 multilingual learners in sustainable schools	68%	29%
Middle grade multilingual learners in sustainable schools	64%	11%

Stable enrollment supports stable staffing, consistent core academics and electives, and, for students moving from K-8s, middle schools with multi-year elective pathways and high school credit in world language and Algebra.

Students with Disabilities: There is no reduction in specialized programming, Learning Center programming or related services for students with disabilities, and caseloads hold steady or improve in 2027-28. PPS will add two Communication Behavior classrooms in Fall 2027, and IEP teams will develop individualized transition plans for each student who moves.

Dual Language Immersion: The total number of seats in each DLI program is unchanged. New Spanish hub bus routes will serve all DLI students rather than only native and heritage speakers, and native speakers will be able to enroll directly at their regional program instead of through the lottery.

How the Recommendation Was Shaped

The recommendation is guided by four principles adopted by the Board in Resolution 7307: well-resourced schools, safe and healthy learning environments, educational options, and the PPS Equity Lens. It draws on enrollment forecasts from Portland State University's Population Research Center, facility capacity data and historical enrollment patterns. It also reflects more than 3,400 survey responses, engagement sessions with more than 1,000 participants across communities, and 35 Superintendent site visits.

Scenario A proposed 14 closures and Scenario B proposed 11. The final recommendation closes 10 schools, while still bringing half of the elementary schools to sustainable enrollment. Changes that reflect concerns raised by students, families, staff and other PPS communities, and further analysis include:

- Sellwood Middle School, James John, Maplewood and Stephenson will remain open.
- Sunnyside remains an environmental focus school, but converts to K-5.
- Skyline students will continue on to Lincoln High School rather than Roosevelt.
- The Odyssey K-8 choice program moves to co-locate with Forest Park instead of Metropolitan Learning Center.
- The Mandarin DLI program at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. remains at its current location.
- Lewis, Marysville, Woodmere and Rose City Park will close in Fall 2028 instead of Fall 2027.

Financial Impact and Reinvestment

Consolidation captures an estimated 75 FTE in structural efficiencies that are not available if PPS keeps operating the same number of buildings, while keeping class size ratios unchanged. Net recurring savings are projected at about $10.2 million across both years. After one-time transition costs, about $7.1 million remains to reinvest in receiving schools, transportation and transition supports, including 15-20 FTE reserved for schools welcoming new students.

Implementation

The changes will be phased in over two years. PPS will carry out the Board's rightsizing decisions through supported transitions and clear steps that deliver on the district's commitments to students, families and staff. Implementation is centered on student wellbeing, belonging and learning. It supports school communities through transition while the district expands student access to sustainable, well-resourced schools.

Implementation planning is already underway and will adjust to the Board's final decision. Once the Board votes in December, PPS will begin working with school communities on student supports and programming, enrollment and transfers, staffing, and facilities and operations. Quarterly public reports will track progress, surface lessons learned, and flag equity gaps so the district can adjust as the work continues. Annual summative reports to the board will provide additional comprehensive learning.

Ongoing Review and Next Steps

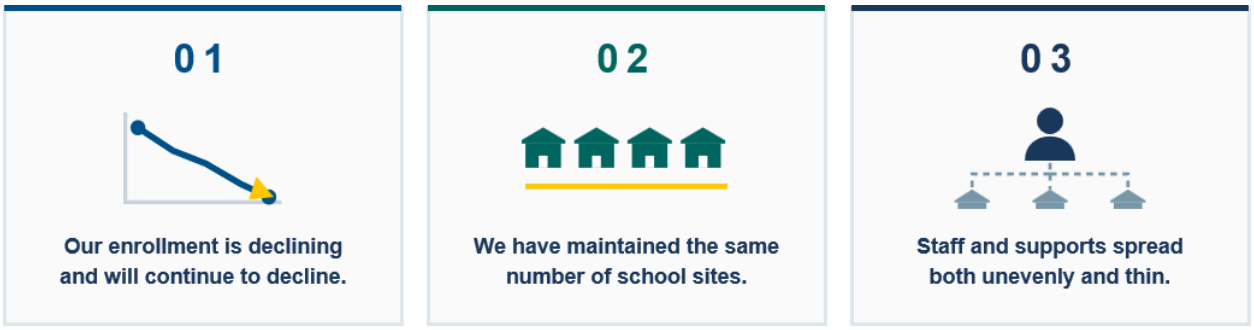
PPS will review enrollment annually. The Superintendent's Enrollment Advisory Committee will become a standing committee overseeing implementation, followed by a systemwide middle school review in 2029-30 and regional boundary reviews beginning on the west side. Starting as early as January 2027, community advisory groups will recommend future uses for each closed building.

The Superintendent presents the recommendation to the Board on November 17. Listening sessions to follow at Franklin High School (November 19) and Grant High School (December 3). In addition, a community information session will be held at McDaniel High School (November 21) with the final Board vote on December 15, 2026.

Change is hard for school communities, and PPS does not take these decisions lightly. But these decisions have been delayed long enough, and acting now puts the district on a more stable footing for every student.

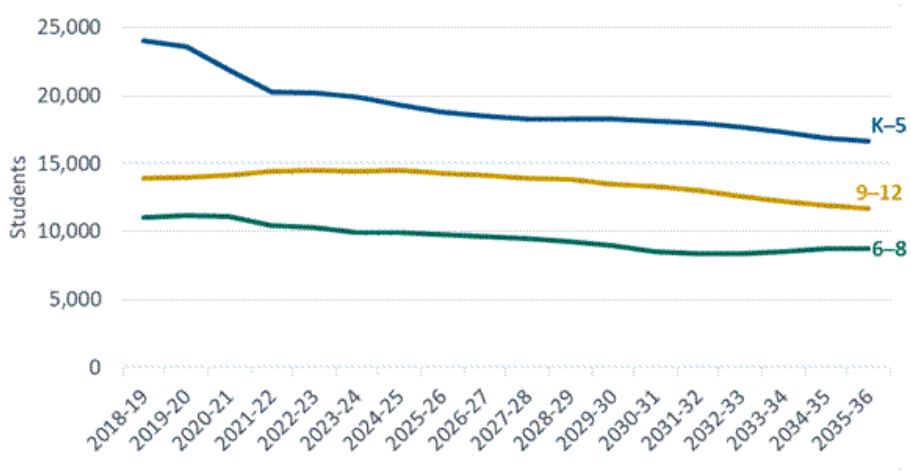
Call to Action

Portland Public Schools is committed to ensuring well-resourced sustainable schools so that every student has equitable access to a robust and high-quality educational experience throughout their careers regardless of where they live in our city. For the better part of a decade, declining enrollment has increased the number of small schools that cannot provide the level of programming and supports students deserve within available resources. The Portland State University Population Research Center (PRC) forecasts additional enrollment loss over the next decade.



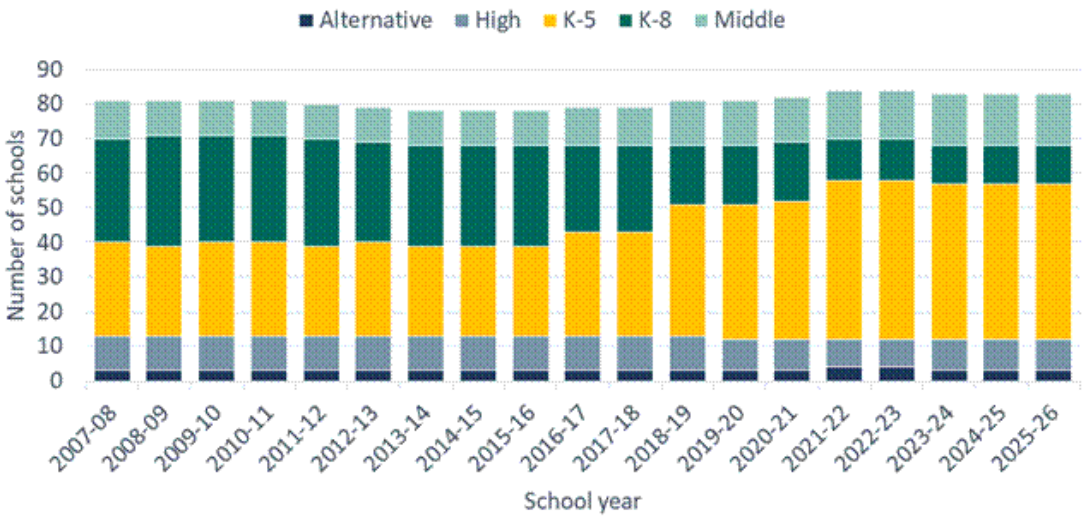
Enrollment declined by 12% between 2018-2019 and 2025-2026, with the deepest declines seen in the elementary grades. Those effects are projected to spread through grades 6-12.

Enrollment Change by Grade Band



Source: PSU Population Research Center Enrollment Forecast (2025-26 to 2034-35)

School Count by Type and Year



PPS has addressed the challenge of declining enrollment through use of one-time COVID funds and budget reserves, increasing class sizes, reducing student support positions and implementing more grade level blends. In addition, for the better part of a decade, we have been taking resources from our high schools to subsidize our shrinking elementary, K-8, and middle schools. The subsidy is approximately 20 full-time equivalent (FTE) positions to support the K-8 model and another 20 for dual language immersion in grades K-5 where programs are co-located.

The Pinch of Shrinking Resources

Blended grade bands	**Arts educators split across schools**	**Libraries open part of the week**
Limited electives for grades 6–8	**Coaching and intervention reduced**	**Principal on duty 2–3 hours a day**

School communities, and particularly our teachers, have worked diligently to absorb these cuts and maintain positive experiences for students. However, their efforts have not been sufficient to stave off further deterioration of student opportunities. Additional actions are necessary.

Beginning in the summer of 2025, PPS undertook a multi-pronged initiative to develop a more sustainable portfolio of schools. Phase I, Growing Great Schools, is an ongoing enrollment growth campaign. Phase II, Jefferson is Rising, set new boundaries and enrollment expectations for Jefferson, Grant, McDaniel and Roosevelt high schools. In April, 2026, the PPS Board of Directors passed Resolution 7296, directing the

Superintendent to initiate a districtwide rightsizing process to consider school and program consolidations, boundary adjustments, special program changes, and grade reconfigurations. Following a series of listening sessions, the Board endorsed a set of guiding principles, timeline and deliverable requirements for the project through Resolution 7307. The Rightsizing effort is aligned with the PPS Student Assignment to Neighborhood Schools (4.10.045-P), Educational Options (6.10.022-P) and School Initiation and Closure (6.10.030-P) policies.

Rightsizing is a necessary mechanism for creating more stable and predictable school enrollment, which is a critical component in assuring equitable access to the robust programming and individualized supports students need to thrive. We know this work carries real impact. The enrollment declines through 2025-26, while currently concentrated in the elementary grades, will continue impacting schools in every part of our city. Eighty-nine percent of the enrollment decline since 2018-19 has been felt in the elementary schools. The leading edge of this decline will enter the middle grades in the next six years accounting for 43% decrease. Because middle schools only have three grades, the impacts will sweep through swiftly and dramatically, leaving the vast majority of middle schools with low enrollment. For K-8s which support students in both grade bands the declines are persistent and leave schools with low enrollment in both the elementary and middle grade bands. High school enrollment stays fairly stable through 2031-32, so the scenarios are designed to stabilize elementary, K-8 and middle schools.

Approach

PPS developed two scenarios and the final recommendation guided by a set of criteria that reflect what the district is trying to achieve: schools large enough to offer stable, adequately resourced programming, buildings that are used well, and school communities that stay together through change as much as possible. In addition, throughout the development process PPS looked at the changes through our equity lens which considers who is impacted by the proposals attending particularly to students who are most underserved in our system.

Guiding Principles

PPS Rightsizing is led by four Guiding Principles that were co-developed by PPS leadership and the Board of Education and informed by community engagement and Board policy.

Adopted May 26, 2026 · Resolution 7307

Well-Resourced Schools

Sustainable, well-resourced schools that provide consistent access to strong academic programming across Portland Public Schools.

Safe and Healthy Learning Environments

Aligning school facilities and learning environments to support student safety, wellness and long-term sustainability.

Educational Options

Maintaining a strong network of neighborhood schools (while providing a balance of

PPS Equity Lens

educational options) that are sustainable and well-resourced.	Using the PPS Equity Lens to guide decision-making and center students most impacted by inequities.

Well Resourced Schools offer comparable, sustainable, and rich academic programming at all grade levels and across the district so students can attend engaging learning spaces that meet their needs and are buffered from enrollment fluctuations. Components include:

- Stable staffing, with qualified educators and specialists who have collaborative schedules, appropriate time for shared planning, and fewer educators split across multiple buildings or roles.
- Rigorous, culturally responsive core academics and elective offerings, including arts, world language, physical education, athletics, interventions and acceleration.
- Access to culturally specific partnerships, mental health and nursing supports, and family and community resources.
- Learning within a facility that supports core and enrichment programming.
- Safe, healthy, comfortable facilities that are in the best of condition.

In well resourced schools, students can get the support they need every day of the week.

Examples of well-resourced experiences by school level

K–5	• 2–3 sections per grade • Weekly arts, library and PE • Intervention and tutoring based on need • Counseling and nursing support on site
6–8	• 6–8 sections per grade • Full elective rotation: arts, world language • Intervention based on need • Counseling and nursing support on site
9–12	• Staffing and courses that support graduation • 2+ languages, sequential arts, AP/IB/Dual Credit • 9th grade success and credit recovery • Counseling and nursing support on site

Safe and Healthy Learning Environments provide welcoming learning environments that are conducive to student success and well-being. PPS will steward its resources responsibly, maintain a sustainable set of school facilities in good condition, and prioritize walkability and safe routes to school.

In safe and healthy learning environments, students do not have to travel on buses for hours each day, and students have spaces at school where they can play and move safely.

Educational Options: PPS provides neighborhood schools and a range of alternative programs, all of which will be considered as part of the rightsizing process.

- Neighborhood schools are the foundation of the system and access to strong, sustainable neighborhood schools is a priority.
- Access to choice programs is balanced with the goal of assuring well-resourced neighborhood schools across the district.

Focus Option	Dual Language Immersion	Alternative
Buckman K5 (s)	Chinese 3 pathways	ACCESS Academy (p)
Creative Science K8 (s)	Japanese 1 pathway	Alliance High School (s)
Odyssey K8 (p)	Russian 1 pathway	Metropolitan Learning Center K12 (s)
Sunnyside Environmental K8 (s)	Spanish 9 pathways	
Winterhaven K8 (s)	Vietnamese 1 pathway	
DaVinci MS (s)		
Benson HS (s)		
Jefferson HS (s)		

Key: (p) program, (s) school

This means that PPS will look to balance students' access to a strong and stable neighborhood school close to where they live while also providing the opportunity to access specialized learning experiences that choice schools and programs offer.

This balance is built on the foundation of neighborhood schools which afford students the opportunities to move with their peers through our system, helping them develop strong relationships both within the school day and in activities or athletics. For example this means assuring that the school close to where students live has athletic programs that connect to the high school. In addition students also have opportunities (within their region) for smaller settings where they can pursue an interest such as science or math.

PPS Equity Lens is a tool to evaluate decisions at all levels, including rightsizing, to disrupt systemic oppression and advance the district's continuous improvement and equity goals. PPS applies the Equity Lens to inform decision-making which considers the district's most impacted focal students based upon our data (Native students, Black students, multilingual learners, students receiving special education services, and students experiencing poverty). An equity checkpoint occurs at each step in the Rightsizing process.

Equity Checkpoints

Stage	Equity Checkpoint	What It Produces
Workgroups and Criteria	Who benefits, who carries burden, and what could our criteria miss?	Disaggregated benefit and burden analysis

Scenarios and Clusters	What does this mean for these students, in this community, with this history?	An equity analysis review attached to every scenario
Readiness and Decision	Is this equitable and ready, and what must be true before it advances?	Required mitigation and an Equity Impact Statement
Implementation	Are our intended outcomes happening?	Disaggregated monitoring and course correction

The PPS equity lens serves as a guidepost so students and families who live in our historically underserved communities have access to vibrant academics without having to leave their neighborhood.

Essential Data

The model uses core data sets structured into four primary inputs and a unified output.

Core Data Sets

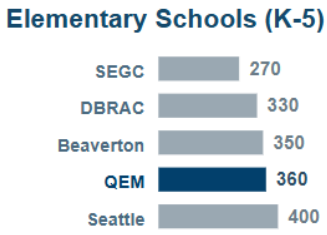
Data Source	Origin / Format	Description & Operational Purpose
Base Projections	Portland State University Population Research Center	10-year official enrollment projections broken down by school, group (program type/residency), grade (PK–12), and year. Baseline year: 2025–26 (actual enrollment). Projections through 2031–32.
Scenario Configuration	Portland Public Schools Central Office Administration	User-defined policy moves (e.g., “Merge School A into School B” or “Transition School C to K–5”) specifying percentage moves, grade ranges, implementation year, and phased vs. immediate timing.
Historical Proportions	PPS 3-Year Historical Averages	Granular matrix mapping how students enrolled in specific schools and programs naturally distribute back across home neighborhood boundaries, supporting 1-to-many closures.
Facility Capacity Data	PPS Facility Operations	Standardized building capacity numbers, classroom counts, square footage, and baseline utilization rates from the District Utilization model.
Unified Output	Result Table	Centralized storage location feeding Power BI dashboards for real-time visualization and comparative scenario analysis. All outputs originate

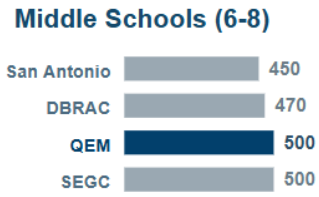
	from the same source, ensuring accuracy of reporting.

PPS references other key areas of information in addition to the core data sets.

Planning floors or enrollment thresholds were determined by using three comparators: what peer districts use for their planning purposes, prototype school models such as the Quality Education Model, and our past practices. PPS used these to determine the floors for the current enrollment process. Because PPS continues to experience enrollment decline, floors that are slightly higher were selected to buffer against future declines.

Comparative School Size Models





PPS did not find comparable models for K-8 schools, so the middle school planning floor was used. In addition, we used the 1,100 student planning floor for high schools which was developed and applied last year when we ended dual assignments for Jefferson High School. The thresholds closely align with enrollment PPS modeled for well-resourced schools, which are focused on the number of homerooms per grade at the elementary (2-3) and the number of sections in middle school (6-8 per grade level), as well as mock-up schedules for high schools. These models represent the lower end of the enrollment range for each school. The upper end is determined by the functional capacity of a school site. For example, Chapman Elementary's enrollment range is between 360, the elementary school baseline, and 464, its functional capacity.

- **SEGC Audit:** To learn from past balancing efforts, PPS commissioned an independent equity audit of the Southeast Enrollment and Program Balancing initiative (SEGC) led by Dr. Terrance L. Green. The SEGC Equity Audit Evaluation found that the process generally improved enrollment balance and, in some places, created more coherent dual language immersion programs. Impacts varied by school and community, however; for example, staffing disruptions in the first year fell hardest on staff of color. The audit recommended that future processes feature:
    - Clear and strong equity commitments
    - Clearer decision-making criteria
    - Transparent and accessible data
    - Early and meaningful engagement
    - Receiving school readiness plans
    - Durable transition supports
    - Tracking of cumulative burden on communities

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

The KPIs were developed from the guiding principles and factors outlined in Board policies. The KPIs compare scenarios with each other and with the current state (no changes), and help surface tradeoffs.

They fall into three categories: opportunity and stability indicators, physical environment and pathway indicators, and balance and impact indicators. The following diagrams show the intersections of the guiding principals, Board policies, and specific indicators.

Opportunity and Stability Indicators

Factor / Guiding Principle	Description	Analysis Metrics
Guiding Principle **Well-Resourced Schools** **Board Policy Factor** **Right Balance** *(program and enrollment stability in surrounding schools)*	**Do students have access to stable, comparable learning environments across our district?** The size difference between the largest and smallest schools affects the ability for schools to offer comparable academic programming. The range is an indicator of how variable the students' experiences may be. We are looking for progress toward increased parity in programming, and this is one way to track our progress.	• Percent of schools at a grade level with enrollment above threshold (e.g., % of K–5 schools with enrollment > 360) • Percent of focal students enrolled in schools above the threshold (e.g., % of students receiving special education services enrolled in K–5, K–8 and middle schools above the thresholds) • Range of enrollment (largest – smallest school) by grade configuration

Physical Environment and Pathway Indicators

Factor / Guiding Principle	Description	Analysis Metrics
Guiding Principle **Safe and Healthy Schools** **Board Policy Factor** **Right Use of Space**	Are we using school spaces to support academic programming and sustainability?	• Percent of efficiently utilized schools in grade band with utilization between 70–100%
Guiding Principle **Safe and Healthy Schools** **Board Policy Factor** **Right Boundaries**	Are school boundaries compact, allowing students to have safe routes to school?	• Percent of students living within 1.0 and 1.5 miles of school

Board Policy Factor **Right Pathways**	Are students able to continue together from one grade level to the next?	• Number of schools with split feeders • Percent of middle school students moving to the same high school

Balance and Impact Indicators for Scenarios

Factor / Guiding Principle	Description	Analysis Metrics
Guiding Principle **PPS Equity Lens** **Board Policy Factor** **Right Impact**	Who moves as a result of these changes? Are the impacts similar across student groups?	• Percent of focal students who will experience the change
Guiding Principle **PPS Equity Lens**	Who is impacted by the changes? Which communities benefit and which are burdened?	• Number of Title I and CSI/TSI schools impacted by the change
Guiding Principle **PPS Equity Lens** **Board Policy** **Right Impact**	How many students are impacted by the changes? Who is impacted by the changes?	• Number of students moving to a new school or site

PPS modeled multiple options and used the KPIs to examine whether each configuration would create stronger, comparable or more challenging conditions for students. The analysis considered:

- Building utilization rates and functional capacity;
- Existing conditions at both sending and receiving schools; including how they affect safe and reliable operations;
- The number of students affected by changes in those conditions;
- Trade-offs across indicators rather than relying on a single indicator or data point;
- Improvements or mitigation needed for a receiving school to successfully serve additional students;
- Equity impacts across all indicators, including whether particular student groups experience disproportionate benefits or burdens.

Community Voice

Community voice shaped Rightsizing from the start. It informed the Guiding Principles and the KPIs used to evaluate every option, and it directly shaped the Superintendent's Recommendation.

After Scenarios A and B were released, PPS gathered input in two complementary ways.

Community feedback survey: Offered in all PPS-supported languages, the survey received more than 3,400 responses from parents and guardians, staff, students and community members across all school communities. Respondents rated the scenarios against the Guiding Principles, weighed tradeoffs and described the support their school communities would need.

Community engagement sessions: From October 6-29, PPS heard from more than 1,000 people in smaller conversations designed for deeper listening, including students, educators, and culturally specific sessions for historically underrepresented communities:

- **Village Table:** A districtwide family and community advisory group.
- **Community Voice conversations:** Dedicated sessions for Native, Black/African American and Latino/a/e families, and for families of students in Special Education.
- **School Impact Sessions:** Regional sessions in North, Southeast and West Portland for the school communities most affected by proposed changes.
- **Board Community Connections:** Open sessions, in-person and virtual, where community members could connect directly with school board members.
- **Educator Town Halls:** Dedicated sessions for PPS educators.
- **Student voice:** Input from student leadership groups, including the District Student Council, Student Voice Advisory Council, Native Student Council, Black Student Union, and middle school groups.

Key Themes & Overall Learnings from Community Engagement

Across all engagement formats, participants expressed a shared recognition that the district faces real structural challenges and that status quo operations are unsustainable. However, community members consistently emphasized that *how* the district approaches these changes is just as critical as the changes themselves. Eight themes emerged from the sessions:

- **Neighborhood preservation with closures as a last resort:** Families and educators view neighborhood schools as community anchors. While acknowledging the need for action, participants urged the district to exhaust other operational and boundary adjustments before considering school closures.
- **Need for operational clarity and implementation capacity:** Communities requested clear, concrete details regarding the day-to-day student experience, school staffing models, and logistics. Many expressed concern about the district's administrative capacity to execute large-scale, simultaneous transitions effectively.
- **Protection of Special Education and transition supports:** Families and staff emphasized that students receiving special education services require robust, individualized transition plans and guaranteed continuity of support throughout any structural changes.
- **Equitable access to Spanish Dual Language Immersion (DLI):** Significant concern was raised regarding the potential consolidation of Spanish DLI programs and the risk of reducing access for historically underserved students.
- **Transportation and geographic realities:** Participants highlighted transportation as a major barrier to consolidation, specifically pointing to the unique topography, traffic bottlenecks, and limited transit

infrastructure on Portland's west side. Additionally, many east side families were concerned about losing walkable and bikeable commutes to school.

- **Divergent views on grade configuration (K–8 vs. middle school):** Feedback reflected mixed community priorities regarding school models; while many families deeply value the stability and tight-knit environment of K–8 schools, others welcome the expanded academic, elective, and extracurricular opportunities offered by comprehensive middle schools.
- **Skepticism toward data used by the district:** Several participants questioned the accuracy, transparency, and framing of the enrollment and capacity data used to justify proposed changes, calling for clearer methodologies to rebuild trust.

Summaries of survey results and community engagement received are available in the What We Heard section on Rightsizing website.

Options

The guiding principles criteria often pull in different directions. Keeping a school community together may require a larger boundary change. Consolidating a small immersion program may lengthen some students' trips. For that reason, the criteria were weighed against one another rather than applied as a fixed ranking, and the balance struck differs from one part of the city to another, because conditions differ. The scenarios and final recommendation varied mostly on which schools would close and phasing the implementation over two years.

A comparison of current and projected enrollment to the minimum enrollment thresholds led to a focus on K-5, K-8 and middle schools, where enrollment decline has been most pervasive and the majority of schools do not meet the standard.

High school changes in both options were limited to feeder pattern and boundary shifts that created stronger K-12 continuity. While declining enrollment is expected to impact high schools in the coming years, almost all high schools are forecast to remain about the 1,100 student standard through 2031-32.

Scenarios A and B

The guiding question for scenario development: How can we make sure more students attend schools with enough enrollment to sustain stable, well-resourced programs, while also using our buildings efficiently?

On October 6, 2026, two options were presented for consideration. Both scenarios sought to stabilize enrollment, strengthen academic program pathways, and align the district's use of school facilities with student needs. They combined school consolidations, grade reconfigurations, program moves and boundary changes to achieve these outcomes. While school consolidations represented the most intense level of change, analysis showed that higher levels of enrollment stability, particularly for focal student groups, could not be achieved through boundary change and program/grade level reconfigurations alone.

Scenario A proposed 14 school closures, while Scenario B proposed 11. The primary differences concerned Stephenson, Rose City Park, and Lewis, which would have closed under Scenario A and remained open under Scenario B. Scenario B would have affected fewer families and changed fewer boundaries, while leaving 43% of schools below the enrollment needed for stable, sustainable programming. Scenario A would have involved more transitions and boundary changes while bringing 67% of schools to sustainable enrollment levels.

District leaders and planning staff developed the two proposed scenarios using criteria focused on enrollment sufficient to sustain stable, adequately resourced programming, effective use of buildings, and keeping school communities together as much as possible.

RIGHTSIZING

PORTLAND | Public Schools

Comparing three scenarios

Portland Public Schools has more school buildings than our enrollment supports. This compares what the district would look like under each of three scenarios.

WHAT GUIDES THE WORK

Well-resourced schools
Consistent access to strong academic programming across PPS.

Educational options
A strong network of neighborhood schools balanced with educational options.

Safe and healthy learning environments
Facilities that support student safety, wellness, and long-term sustainability.

PPS equity lens
Centering students most impacted by inequities in every decision.

The three scenarios

All figures are projections for the **2031–32 school year** unless noted.

SCENARIO A

Closures, program moves, and boundary changes bring about two thirds of schools up to a sustainable size. About 80% of students will attend a sustainable school.

SCENARIO B

A smaller set of the same moves brings more than half of schools up to a sustainable size. About 73% of students will attend a sustainable school.

STATUS QUO

No schools close and no boundaries change. Enrollment keeps declining, so more schools fall below the size needed to staff a full program. About 48% of students will attend a sustainable school.

District-wide, side by side

Measure	SCENARIO A	SCENARIO B	STATUS QUO
Schools or sites that would close	14	11	0
Students who would change schools	27%	24%	0%
Schools above the sustainability threshold	67%	57%	26%
Students attending a school above the threshold	80%	73%	48%
Students Experiencing Poverty in Sustainable Schools	81%	74%	42%
Historically Underserved Students in Sustainable Schools	83%	78%	46%
Students Receiving Special Education Services in Sustainable Schools	77%	69%	41%
Multilingual Learners in Sustainable Schools	87%	77%	44%

SUSTAINABILITY THRESHOLDS **K–5:** 360 students | **K–8 and middle school:** 500 students | **High school:** 1,100 students

RIGHTSIZING · SCENARIO COMPARISON

What changes under each scenario

Every school affected, district-wide, grouped by the kind of change.

PORTLAND | Public Schools

STATUS QUO	0 schools close	26% of schools above threshold	48% of students in those schools	0% students change schools

SCENARIO A

14 schools close	67% schools above threshold	27% K–8 students move

⊗ SCHOOLS CLOSING* — 14

Beach · Buckman · Creston · Irvington · James John · Lewis · Maplewood · Marysville · Peninsula · Rose City Park · Sabin · Sellwood MS · Stephenson · Woodmere

◫ ATTENDANCE BOUNDARY CHANGES — 38

Abernethy · Arleta · Astor · Atkinson · Beaumont MS · Beverly Cleary · Brentwood MS · Capitol Hill · Chief Joseph · Cleveland HS · Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. · Duniway · Faubion · Franklin HS · George MS · Harriet Tubman MS · Harrison Park MS · Hayhurst · Hosford MS · Jackson MS · Jefferson HS · Kellogg MS · Kelly · Lent · Lincoln HS · Llewellyn · Markham · McDaniel · Mt. Tabor MS · Ockley Green MS · Rieke · Robert Gray MS · Roosevelt HS · Rosa Parks · Scott · Sitton · Sunnyside Environmental · Whitman

→ PROGRAM MOVES — 13

Spanish: Beach, James John, and Sitton to Cesar Chavez · Atkinson to Lent · Scott to Rigler · Beaumont MS to Roseway Heights MS · Chavez 6–8 and Ockley Green MS to George MS · Vietnamese: Rose City Park to Vestal · Mandarin: Clark to Woodstock · MLK Jr. to Boise-Eliot/Humboldt · Creston Deaf and Hard of Hearing to Glencoe · Odyssey moves to the MLC site

⇅ GRADE-LEVEL CHANGES — 8

Beverly Cleary 6–8 to Beaumont MS · Laurelhurst 6–8 to Mt. Tabor MS · Bridger Creative Science 6–8 to Harrison Park MS · Sunnyside Environmental 6–8 to Hosford MS · Faubion 6–8 to Ockley Green MS · Vernon 6–8 to Harriet Tubman MS · Chavez 6-8 to George · MLC becomes K-8

SCENARIO B

11 schools close	57% schools above threshold	24% K–8 students move

⊗ SCHOOLS CLOSING* — 11

Beach · Buckman · Creston · Irvington · James John · Maplewood · Marysville · Peninsula · Sabin · Sellwood MS · Woodmere

◫ ATTENDANCE BOUNDARY CHANGES — 34

Abernethy · Arleta · Astor · Atkinson · Beaumont MS · Beverly Cleary · Brentwood MS · Chief Joseph · Cleveland HS · Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. · Faubion · Franklin HS · George MS · Harriet Tubman MS · Harrison Park MS · Hayhurst · Hosford MS · Jackson MS · Jefferson HS · Kellogg MS · Kelly · Lent · Lewis · Lincoln HS · McDaniel · Mt. Tabor MS · Ockley Green MS · Rieke · Robert Gray MS · Roosevelt HS · Rosa Parks · Sitton · Sunnyside Environmental · Whitman

→ PROGRAM MOVES — 12

Spanish: Beach, James John, and Sitton to Cesar Chavez · Atkinson to Lent · Scott to Rigler · Beaumont MS to Roseway Heights MS · Chavez 6–8 and Ockley Green MS to George MS · Mandarin: Clark to Woodstock · MLK Jr. to Boise-Eliot/Humboldt · Creston Deaf and Hard of Hearing to Glencoe · Odyssey moves to the MLC site

⇅ GRADE-LEVEL CHANGES — 8

Beverly Cleary 6–8 to Beaumont MS · Laurelhurst 6–8 to Mt. Tabor MS · Bridger Creative Science 6–8 to Harrison Park MS · Sunnyside Environmental 6–8 to Hosford MS · Faubion 6–8 to Ockley Green MS · Vernon 6–8 to Harriet Tubman MS · Chavez 6-8 to George · MLC becomes K-8

* The MLC (9–12) high school program also closes; students move to their neighborhood high school. It is not counted as a school closure.

Updated October 4, 2026

RIGHTSIZING · REGIONAL SUMMARY

Jefferson / Roosevelt region

Schools in the Jefferson and Roosevelt high school areas, compared across three scenarios. Status quo: no schools close and no boundaries change.

PORTLAND | Public Schools

Updated October 3, 2026

SCENARIO A 4 schools close

SCENARIO B 4 schools close

STATUS QUO 0 schools close

Scenarios A and B close the same schools in this region, so their results are nearly identical.

Jefferson / Roosevelt, side by side

Projections for the **2031–32** school year

Measure	SCENARIO A	SCENARIO B	STATUS QUO
Schools that would close	4	4	0
Schools above the sustainability threshold	73%	73%	16%
Students attending a school above the threshold	82%	82%	36%
Students Experiencing Poverty in Sustainable Schools	84%	84%	32%
Historically Underserved Students in Sustainable Schools	85%	85%	35%
Students Receiving Special Education Services in Sustainable Schools	80%	80%	26%
Multilingual Learners in Sustainable Schools	92%	92%	34%

SUSTAINABILITY THRESHOLDS — **K–5:** 360 students | **K–8 and middle school:** 500 students | **High school:** 1,100 students

What changes under each scenario

Every school affected in this region, by kind of change. Boundary changes include schools that gain or lose area.

SCENARIOS A AND B (SAME CHANGES IN THIS REGION)

⊗ SCHOOLS CLOSING — 4

Beach · James John · Peninsula · Sabin

◫ ATTENDANCE BOUNDARY CHANGES — 11

Astor · Chief Joseph · Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. · Faubion · George MS · Harriet Tubman MS · Jefferson HS · Ockley Green MS · Roosevelt HS · Rosa Parks · Sitton

→ PROGRAM MOVES — 6

Spanish: Beach, James John, and Sitton to Cesar Chavez · Spanish: Chavez 6–8 and Ockley Green MS to George MS · Mandarin: MLK Jr. to Boise-Eliot/Humboldt

↑↓ GRADE-LEVEL CHANGES — 3

Faubion 6–8 to Ockley Green MS · Vernon 6–8 to Harriet Tubman MS · Chavez 6-8 to George

RIGHTSIZING · REGIONAL SUMMARY

Grant / McDaniel region

Schools in the Grant and McDaniel high school areas, compared across three scenarios. Status quo: no schools close and no boundaries change.

PORTLAND | Public Schools

Updated October 3, 2026

SCENARIO A 2 schools close | **SCENARIO B** 1 school closes | **STATUS QUO** 0 schools close

Grant / McDaniel, side by side

Projections for the **2031–32** school year

Measure	SCENARIO A	SCENARIO B	STATUS QUO
Schools that would close	2	1	0
Schools above the sustainability threshold	69%	57%	40%
Students attending a school above the threshold	82%	75%	59%
Students Experiencing Poverty in Sustainable Schools	85%	74%	53%
Historically Underserved Students in Sustainable Schools	87%	77%	57%
Students Receiving Special Education Services in Sustainable Schools	78%	68%	57%
Multilingual Learners in Sustainable Schools	87%	79%	48%

SUSTAINABILITY THRESHOLDS — **K–5:** 360 students | **K–8 and middle school:** 500 students | **High school:** 1,100 students

What changes under each scenario

Every school affected in this region, by kind of change. Boundary changes include schools that gain or lose area.

SCENARIO A

⊗ SCHOOLS CLOSING 2
Irvington · Rose City Park

◫ ATTENDANCE BOUNDARY CHANGES 5
Beaumont MS · Beverly Cleary · McDaniel · Scott · Harrison Park MS

→ PROGRAM MOVES 4
Spanish: Scott to Rigler · Spanish: Beaumont MS to Roseway Heights MS · Vietnamese: Rose City Park to Vestal · Mandarin: Clark to Woodstock

⇅ GRADE-LEVEL CHANGES 2
Beverly Cleary 6–8 to Beaumont MS · Laurelhurst 6–8 to Mt. Tabor MS

SCENARIO B

⊗ SCHOOLS CLOSING 1
Irvington

◫ ATTENDANCE BOUNDARY CHANGES 4
Beaumont MS · Beverly Cleary · McDaniel · Harrison Park MS

→ PROGRAM MOVES 3
Spanish: Scott to Rigler · Spanish: Beaumont MS to Roseway Heights MS · Mandarin: Clark to Woodstock

⇅ GRADE-LEVEL CHANGES 2
Beverly Cleary 6–8 to Beaumont MS · Laurelhurst 6–8 to Mt. Tabor MS

RIGHTSIZING · REGIONAL SUMMARY

Cleveland / Franklin region

Schools in the Cleveland and Franklin high school areas, compared across three scenarios. Status quo: no schools close and no boundaries change.

PORTLAND | Public Schools

Updated October 3, 2026

SCENARIO A 6 schools close

SCENARIO B 5 schools close

STATUS QUO 0 schools close

Cleveland / Franklin, side by side

Projections for the **2031–32** school year

Measure	SCENARIO A	SCENARIO B	STATUS QUO
Schools that would close	6	5	0
Schools above the sustainability threshold	71%	59%	19%
Students attending a school above the threshold	82%	73%	38%
Students Experiencing Poverty in Sustainable Schools	81%	75%	36%
Historically Underserved Students in Sustainable Schools	84%	78%	37%
Students Receiving Special Education Services in Sustainable Schools	80%	69%	30%
Multilingual Learners in Sustainable Schools	86%	83%	43%

SUSTAINABILITY THRESHOLDS — **K–5:** 360 students | **K–8 and middle school:** 500 students | **High school:** 1,100 students

What changes under each scenario

Every school affected in this region, by kind of change. Boundary changes include schools that gain or lose area.

SCENARIO A

⊗ SCHOOLS CLOSING 6

Buckman · Creston · Lewis · Marysville · Sellwood MS · Woodmere

◫ ATTENDANCE BOUNDARY CHANGES 15

Abernethy · Arleta · Atkinson · Brentwood MS · Cleveland HS · Duniway · Franklin HS · Hosford MS · Kellogg MS · Kelly · Lent · Llewellyn · Mt. Tabor · Sunnyside Environmental · Whitman

→ PROGRAM MOVES 2

Spanish: Atkinson to Lent · Creston Deaf and Hard of Hearing to Glencoe

⇅ GRADE-LEVEL CHANGES 2

Bridger Creative Science 6–8 to Harrison Park MS · Sunnyside Environmental 6–8 to Hosford MS

SCENARIO B

⊗ SCHOOLS CLOSING 5

Buckman · Creston · Marysville · Sellwood MS · Woodmere

◫ ATTENDANCE BOUNDARY CHANGES 14

Abernethy · Arleta · Atkinson · Brentwood MS · Cleveland HS · Franklin HS · Hosford MS · Kellogg MS · Kelly · Lent · Lewis · Mt. Tabor · Sunnyside Environmental · Whitman

→ PROGRAM MOVES 2

Spanish: Atkinson to Lent · Creston Deaf and Hard of Hearing to Glencoe

⇅ GRADE-LEVEL CHANGES 2

Bridger Creative Science 6–8 to Harrison Park MS · Sunnyside Environmental 6–8 to Hosford MS

RIGHTSIZING · REGIONAL SUMMARY

Ida B. Wells / Lincoln region

Schools in the Ida B. Wells and Lincoln high school areas, compared across three scenarios. Status quo: no schools close and no boundaries change.

PORTLAND | Public Schools

Updated October 4, 2026

SCENARIO A 2 schools close | **SCENARIO B** 1 school closes | **STATUS QUO** 0 schools close

Ida B. Wells / Lincoln, side by side

Projections for the **2031–32** school year

Measure	SCENARIO A	SCENARIO B	STATUS QUO
Schools that would close	2	1	0
Schools above the sustainability threshold	60%	44%	35%
Students attending a school above the threshold	75%	64%	62%
Students Experiencing Poverty in Sustainable Schools	68%	54%	53%
Historically Underserved Students in Sustainable Schools	74%	61%	62%
Students Receiving Special Education Services in Sustainable Schools	71%	59%	54%
Multilingual Learners in Sustainable Schools	74%	58%	58%

SUSTAINABILITY THRESHOLDS — **K–5:** 360 students | **K–8 and middle school:** 500 students | **High school:** 1,100 students

What changes under each scenario

Every school affected in this region, by kind of change. Boundary changes include schools that gain or lose area.

SCENARIO A

⊗ SCHOOLS CLOSING 2
Maplewood · Stephenson

ATTENDANCE BOUNDARY CHANGES 7
Capitol Hill · Hayhurst · Jackson MS · Lincoln HS · Markham · Rieke · Robert Gray MS

→ PROGRAM MOVES 1
Odyssey moves to the MLC site

⇅ GRADE-LEVEL CHANGES 1
MLC becomes K-8

SCENARIO B

⊗ SCHOOLS CLOSING 1
Maplewood

ATTENDANCE BOUNDARY CHANGES 5
Hayhurst · Jackson MS · Lincoln HS · Rieke · Robert Gray MS

→ PROGRAM MOVES 1
Odyssey moves to the MLC site

⇅ GRADE-LEVEL CHANGES 1
MLC becomes K-8

Both scenarios: The MLC (9–12) high school program also closes; students move to their neighborhood high school. It is not counted as a school closure.

For more information on the data and methodology used to develop the scenarios, see the Rightsizing Scenarios section of the PPS Rightsizing website.

Recommendation

After gathering feedback from 44 engagement sessions and 35 superintendent school/community site visits during the fall of 2026, further analysis, and site reviews, PPS developed the Superintendent's recommendation. The set of proposed changes were measured against the overarching goal of improving the educational experience for students across our system. This requires stabilizing staffing and resources at as many schools as possible while also being realistic about our capacity to successfully navigate the changes. These proposed changes will impact students, educators, and communities across our system - shaping who they connect and build relationships with, how they travel through our city, and the opportunities for students to grow and thrive. These changes bring us closer to realizing our vision of schools that develop compassionate critical thinkers able to collaborate and solve problems, and prepared to lead a more socially just world.

The recommendation that follows incorporates the fundamental structure found in both scenarios A and B while also being responsive to the feedback we heard from communities. As we considered adjustments, we returned to the guiding principles and the key performance indicators for comparison to the previous scenarios. We balanced this with considerations about the magnitude of change which drives how soon we will have to review enrollment processes or make adjustments in the future, how many school communities are affected, how many students and educators will be asked to move to a different building where they will forge new relationships. The complexity of the changes where we assess what supports, resources and structures are at each site students will be leaving as well as the community that will receive the students, educators and families. Finally, we also looked at the intensity of the changes that a site will navigate. These considerations helped us determine readiness for the change as well as plan for the intentional and multi-year supports that will be needed to help students and families through this transition. While we have a sense of urgency as we see schools struggling to maintain and sustain robust educational experiences for our students, we also need to handle these decisions with care.

While the goal was to keep as many students together as possible through these moves, we have not been able to keep whole school communities together in all cases. PPS moved whole attendance areas where possible. We heard this concern from families and the call to acknowledge that school communities are not defined by attendance areas, they are built over time and embody the variety of experiences at each school site. They expressed concern about school programs being split from their neighborhood peers when dual language immersion programs or special education focus classrooms moved to different schools than their peers.

The changes outlined in this recommendation are phased over a two year period, beginning in the fall of 2027. The changes in the first year are contingent on each other and also reflect the significant enrollment decline. The recommendation includes changes primarily from Scenario A while applying the magnitude of Scenario B.

The recommendation consolidates resources through school closures, program consolidations, and grade reconfigurations. PPS has schools that are underenrolled at both the elementary and middle grades and this recommendation focuses primarily on those grade levels. School closures occur only at the elementary level and are designed to stabilize the enrollment at the receiving schools as well as within the region. This step is necessary because balanced school enrollment could not be achieved through boundary and program moves alone.

Dual Language Immersion program consolidations are necessary because the resources are spread across too many elementary schools. PPS values dual language immersion and takes pride in providing programs in five different languages. PPS is committed to supporting students in becoming bilingual and learning in rich bicultural settings. Co-located dual language immersion programs are difficult to sustain when they are in elementaries that have less than two strands at each grade. This leads to an imbalance between the dual language immersion and English scholar programs. In recent years we have seen an increase in the number of grade level blends in one program or the other. We are also seeing the impact of difficult decisions that principals of co-located programs are forced to make about how to split limited building resources (e.g. ELD support, instructional coaching, academic intervention, professional learning time, etc) across two instructional programs.

Japanese, Russian and Vietnamese dual language immersion programs will remain open across the district and are each available at one elementary school. Mandarin Chinese Dual Language Immersion has three available elementary pathways which will be consolidated over two years to two, one each in north and southeast Portland. For Spanish Dual Language Immersion the recommendation moves from nine elementaries to four - one in each region. In north Portland students will access Spanish Dual Language immersion at César Chávez K-5, in northeast at Rigler K-5, in southeast at Lent K-5 and in the west at Ainsworth K-5. This will allow us to maintain the research-based 90:10 language allocation model, and will move us closer to the recommended program composition of one third native language speakers, one third heritage language speakers, and one third native English speakers in the program. The total number of seats available in each Dual Language program will remain unchanged.

We heard concerns from families about transportation to the whole school dual language immersion sites not only for students, but also for caregivers. To mitigate transportation concerns PPS is developing hub bus routes that will be available for students who are in the program. While in our current model, DLI transportation is available only to Native and Heritage speakers, the hub bus model will allow us to offer transportation to all students enrolled in DLI programs. See the Sample Transportation Routes document in the appendix for sample travel times for the routes.

In addition, bilingual community agents will work with each school to support families in the transition and to support outreach to families with kindergarten age students to raise awareness of the DLI opportunity. Native speakers will be able to go directly to their program to register, removing the lottery application barrier for families. We heard concerns that we assumed too many students would follow the program to the new site. In response, we lowered our assumption and provided a range of students who may move. PPS will continue to monitor the enrollment in each dual language elementary school and the program from kindergarten through

graduation so that students can flourish in language and cultural rich environments that thrive for years to come.

The recommendation also converts seven K-8 schools to elementaries. Middle grade students from these schools will enroll in adjacent middle schools. These changes provide students with access to more stable and broader academic programming including multiple year elective pathways in the arts or STEM and pre-ninth grade credit in a world language and in Algebra 1-2. These changes also increase enrollment at the middle schools, buffering them to some degree from the enrollment decline that is working its way through the system. These changes also decrease the need to subsidize middle grades programs at K-8s. The K-8s that remain open are in choice programs, geographically isolated, or are in a region that needs additional middle grades seats because of a limited number of middle schools in the area.

Families of students with disabilities provided important input during engagement sessions. They emphasize the critical need to protect dedicated support staff, specialized sensory spaces, and access to smaller learning environments. They request transparent, equitable planning that guarantees day-one service continuity and prevents disproportionate harm to students with intersectionality in addition to disability during any potential school transition.

With the proposed recommendation, there is no decrease in specialized programming, Learning Center programming, or related services for students with disabilities. Currently, the average Learning Center teacher caseload is 26 students per FTE. Projections for 2027-28 show an average Learning Center teacher caseload of 21. Focus programming shows a similar trend. The average Social Emotional Skills (SES) case manager caseload is currently 10 per FTE. Communication Behavior (CB) caseload is 10.5, with Intensive Skills (ISC) at nine. Projections indicate the average teacher caseload per allocated FTE in SES to be nine, CB to be eight and ISC to be 7.5. Current data indicates we will maintain, and in some cases slightly improve, caseload ratios in the 2027-28 school year. Student to staff ratios for related service providers, such as school psychologists and speech and language therapists will be unchanged in the Rightsizing process. All of these supports will continue to meet the service requirements of each IEP.

It is important to note that Special Education data represents actual students and staff and is in constant flux as students move in and out of Special Education or PPS. Every year over 1,000 students who receive special education services transfer in or out of PPS, or are determined by their IEP team to require special education services in a specialized classroom located outside of their neighborhood school. These transitions are required to ensure a continuum of services.

We have heard concerns about the possibility of disproportionate impact on students with disabilities as well as other focal student groups. We acknowledge that additional transitions and changes in programming can have a higher impact on students with disabilities. However, because every student with a disability first and foremost is a general education student, they also participate in the benefits provided by Rightsizing. Currently in the K-8 grade band, there are 56 Specialized Program classrooms. Of those, 36 will experience no direct impact from Rightsizing. Of the 20 impacted, nine of them will move to a new school. The remaining 11 will receive students

from another school or program. That means 16% of our Specialized Programs in K-8 will transition to a new location. While that impact is not to be minimalized, it is proportionate to the overall impact in our system.

PPS strives to keep students in specialized programming with their general education peers and within a school closest to their neighborhood. Each of the schools impacted by Rightsizing has been assessed for adequate space. When considering needed classroom spaces, counts included designated spaces for sensory/regulation, classroom spaces, specialized program spaces, and office spaces. Each site in the recommendation has a verified amount of space for special education programming.

In response to concerns raised about middle school programming, PPS will add two CB classes in fall 2027. One site for CB programming will be Hosford Middle School, which also receives middle school students from Sunnyside. While student IEPs do not include school size as an accommodation, because school size is part of the general education program rather than a special education service, we acknowledge some students may need a different model within their special education services in support of their neurodivergence.

Our parent community has asked important questions about data, impact, and future programming. Additionally, there is a strong focus on making thoughtful transition decisions for each student who will make a transition. The processes that are typically used to transition students with disabilities between school sites, whether due to grade changes or programming changes, must also be carefully applied here. Teams will be expected to make individualized transition plans for students and meet with receiving school colleagues and families to develop thoughtful plans. Students who require additional service or support for a transition will have that designated through the IEP process.

Recommendation Changes Relative to Scenario A

The following summarizes how the Superintendent's recommendation differs from Scenario A.

- **Sellwood Middle School will remain open.** The rationale for keeping it open:
    - Enrollment remains over 500 students for the next two years
    - PPS will monitor enrollment across all middle schools over the next two years, identify schools with enrollment below 400 and will conduct a comprehensive enrollment review in 2029-30 when the remaining three high school modernization projects are complete.
    - The conversion of Sunnyside to a K-5 will support enrollment at Hosford Middle School The remaining three high school modernizations will be complete in the fall of 2029 which may bring students back into PPS.

- **James John K-5 will remain open** and the Spanish Dual Language Immersion program will be available only at César Chávez K-5 in the north region. In both scenarios A and B James John was proposed for closure. The rationale for keeping it open:
    - Overall enrollment is close to the planning floor of 360 students through the 2031-32 school year although actual enrollment this year for 2026 was below the PSU forecast for both Spanish

Dual Language Immersion and English scholar students (see PSU forecast dashboard for more information),
    - PPS will monitor impact of developing dual language immersion hub at César Chávez to see if families decide to move with the program or remain at their neighborhood schools
    - PPS will monitor the enrollment at all of the elementaries (Sitton, James John, Rosa Parks and César Chávez) in the Roosevelt attendance area to track progress toward stable enrollment and progress toward the 360 threshold.
    - Families asked us to revisit our assumptions about the number of students who would choose to move with the program so PPS ran the model again to produce a range of enrollment projections rather than a single number.

- **Maplewood K-5 will remain open.** In both Scenarios A and B, the Maplewood building was proposed for closure. The rationale for keeping it open:
    - Enrollment at Maplewood K-5 moved above 300 students this year which is a multi-year upward trend.
    - PPS heard from community members concerned about the size of a development in the area that may have a significant impact on the Hayhurst K-5 enrollment.
    - PPS will monitor student enrollment at all six K-5 schools in the Ida B. Wells attendance area.

- **Stephenson K-5 will remain open.** In scenario A Stephenson was proposed to close and in scenario B it was proposed to remain open. The rationale for keeping it open:
    - While enrollment at Stephenson has remained below 300 students for the past three years, it has leveled out to around 285 students. PPS will monitor enrollment and if it declines two years in a row a deeper review will be started.
    - PPS will monitor enrollment at elementaries adjacent to Stephenson - Markham K-5 and Capitol Hill K-5. Markham has sustained enrollment around 340 students. Capitol Hill's enrollment declined to below 300 students this year.
    - PPS will monitor student enrollment at all six K-5 schools in the Ida B. Wells attendance area.

- **The Mandarin Chinese DLI Program at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. elementary will stay in its current location.** In both scenarios A and B, the Mandarin Chinese dual language immersion program was proposed to move to Boise-Eliot/Humboldt. The rationale for keeping Mandarin Chinese at Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. includes:
    - The Mandarin Chinese program has been growing over the past two years at its current location, with kindergarten classes around 50 students compared to upper elementary classes with enrollment closer to 30 students.
    - The percentage of Black students enrolled in the dual language immersion program is close to 30% in early elementary compared to roughly 20% in the upper grades.
    - The functional capacity at Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. is 584 students and will be able to accommodate all of the students from Sabin with a projected enrollment in the fall of 2027 of 572. PPS will monitor enrollment and will conduct a site review should utilization exceed 100%.

- PPS will monitor enrollment at adjacent K-5 campuses and at Boise-Eliot/Humboldt in particular to see if it stabilizes. Boise-Eliot/Humboldt has decreased each of the past three years and was 285 this fall, which was below projection.

- **Skyline K-8 students will continue to Lincoln High School.** In both scenarios A and B students from Skyline K-8 were proposed to go to Roosevelt High School. The current high school boundaries for Lincoln and Roosevelt will remain the same. The rationale for this includes:
  - Students at Skyline have established bus routes to Lincoln.
  - PPS will monitor enrollment at all the high schools and revisit feeder patterns should schools fall below the enrollment floor of 1,100 students. Roosevelt is projected to have enrollment of less than 1,200 students in the fall of 2029.

- **Sunnyside Environmental School becomes a neighborhood/focus option K-5.** Sunnyside reconfigures to a K-5 as outlined in the proposals in both Scenario A and B. However, in this recommendation a limited number of students from outside the Sunnyside/Buckman neighborhood would continue to have access to its environmental school program through the lottery. The rationale for this includes:
  - Sunnyside has been a high demand lottery choice (125 applications this year). Retaining the choice portion mitigates the impact of closing the Buckman Arts lottery choice and provides families with access to at least one of the two choice options.
  - Buckman's attendance area is separated into two pieces and the students north of Burnside will attend Sunnyside. The social and emotional special education classrooms also move to Sunnyside from Buckman.
  - Current students who are at Buckman through the lottery process will be able to attend Sunnyside next year or return to their neighborhood school.
  - Native American families shared the importance of maintaining an environmental option during our culturally specific engagements.

- **Odyssey K-8 choice program moves to Forest Park K-5 in 2028-29 and East Sylvan building closes.** In both scenarios A and B Odyssey was proposed to move to the Metropolitan Learning Center (MLC). In this recommendation the location for the program move is to Forest Park K-5. The rationale for this includes:
  - After a walk-through with school-based staff and central office facilities teams, the number of classrooms needed at MLC, while feasible, presented challenges. Space constraints would have required both programs to share some classrooms
  - There is limited capacity to accommodate additional transportation needs, alongside existing constraints on family drop-off and loading space at MLC.
  - Forest Park has a slightly larger capacity (519) compared to MLC (487), and can accommodate both the Forest Park students (264) and the 200 Odyssey students.
  - PPS will monitor the enrollment for both Forest Park and Odyssey to ensure stable and sufficient enrollment to sustain the academic programming needs.

Superintendent's recommendation · North region

North (Jefferson / Roosevelt) region

The North Region's changes are concentrated in 2027–28. Three buildings close: Beach, Peninsula and Sabin — and their students move to Chief Joseph, Cesar Chavez, Rosa Parks, and Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. respectively. Sabin's Social-emotional skills (SES) classrooms move to either Vernon or Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., based on the neighborhood boundary. At the same time, Faubion, Vernon and César Chávez move from K–8 to K–5, sending middle-grade students to Ockley Green, Tubman and George. The K-5 English scholars at César Chávez move to Rosa Parks.

Spanish dual language immersion (DLI) is brought together in one pathway: César Chávez becomes the region's K–5 Spanish DLI hub (welcoming students previously enrolled in Spanish DLI at Beach, Sitton, and James John), and middle-grade Spanish DLI is at George. In 2028–29, one transition finishes: rising 6th graders from the former Peninsula boundary move to George Middle School instead of Ockley Green Middle School.

Recommendation **3** schools close
Beach · Peninsula · Sabin

Status quo/No change **0** schools close
No schools close and no boundaries change.

Projections for the **2031–32** school year

Measure	Recommendation	Status quo/No change
Schools that would close	3	**0**
Schools above the sustainability threshold	56%	**16%**
Students attending a school above the threshold	72%	**36%**
Students Experiencing Poverty in Sustainable Schools	72%	**32%**
Historically Underserved Students in Sustainable Schools	74%	**35%**
Students Receiving Special Education Services in Sustainable Schools	66%	**26%**
Multilingual Learners in Sustainable Schools	85%	**34%**

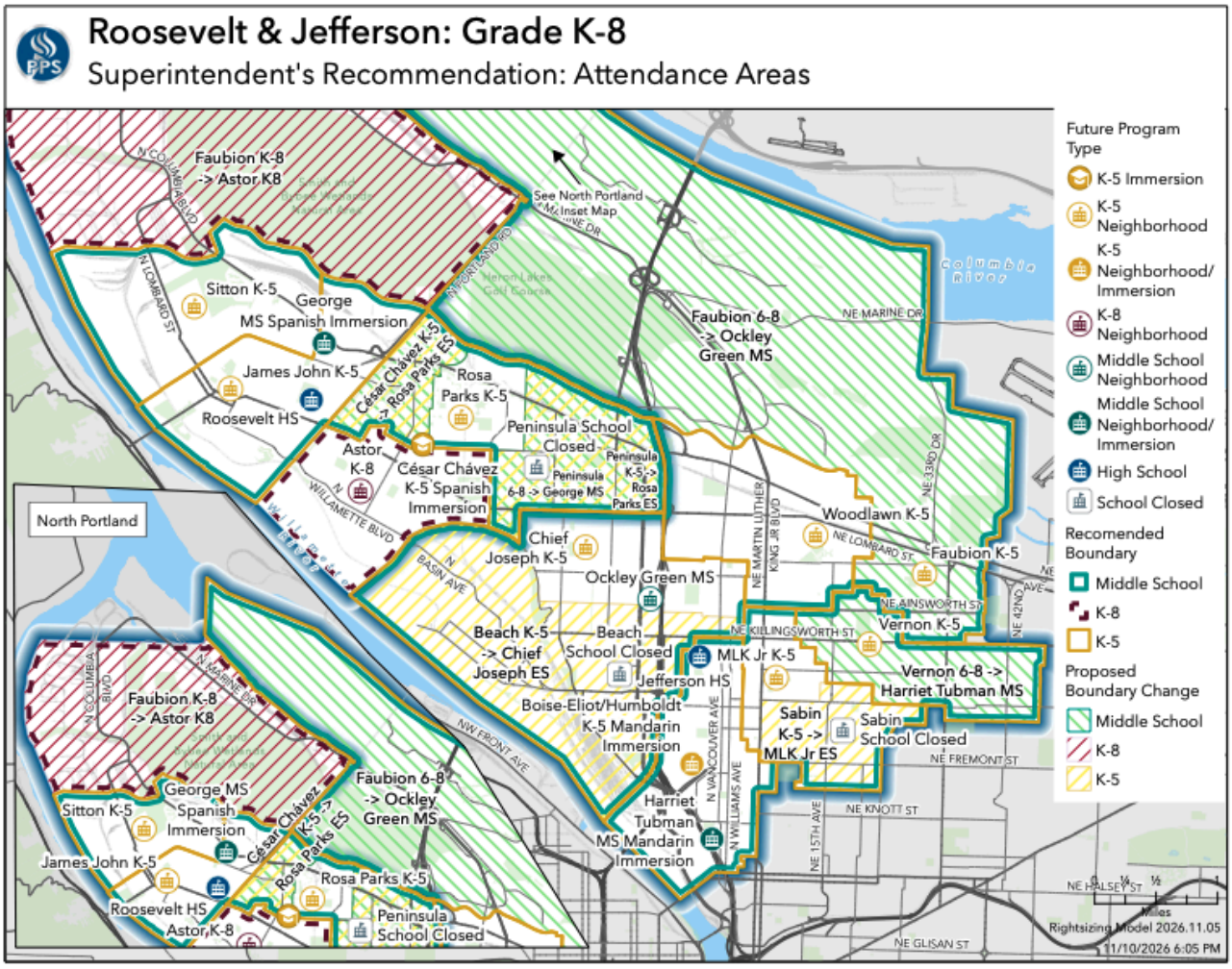
Sustainability thresholds **K–5:** 360 students **K–8 and middle school:** 500 students **High school:** 1,100 students

What changes and when under the recommendation

Read each line as **school** → where students go. Special education changes are noted only where students would attend a different school than their general education peers.

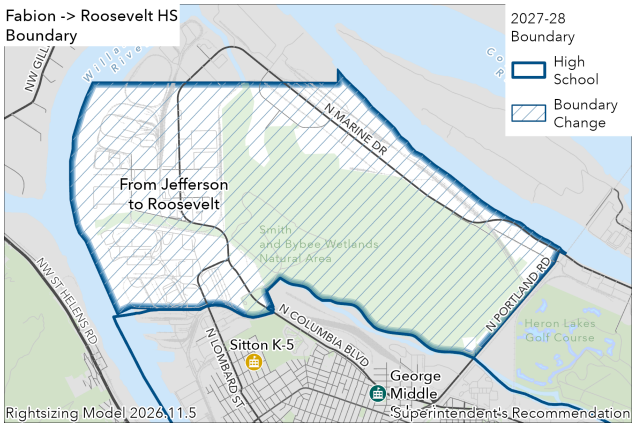
2027–28 school year	2028–29 school year
Closures **Beach** → Chief Joseph, Spanish DLI → César Chávez **Peninsula** → Rosa Parks **Sabin** → Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., SES classrooms → Vernon or Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr.	**Closures** *No closures in 2028–29*
Grade levels & feeders **Faubion** becomes K–5 · 6–8 → Ockley Green **Vernon** becomes K–5 · 6–8 → Tubman **César Chávez** becomes K–5 · 6–8 → George · K-5 English scholars students → Rosa Parks	**Grade levels & feeders** Rising 6th graders from the former Peninsula boundary move to George MS instead of Ockley Green MS → George Middle School
Program moves **César Chávez** becomes K–5 Spanish DLI hub · from Beach, James John, Sitton **George** hosts middle-grade Spanish DLI · from César Chávez, Ockley Green	**Program moves** *No program moves in 2028–29*

North Region Map of Proposed Changes



North Region High School Boundary Changes

A boundary change between Jefferson and Roosevelt is proposed to align K-12 feeder patterns and provide shorter transportation routes to the students in the Bybee Lakes community.



Individual school impact reports

See the school level impact reports for descriptions of proposed changes and impacts. Select a school to go to its report in the attachments.

- Beach ›
- César Chávez ›
- Chief Joseph ›
- Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. ›
- Faubion ›
- George ›
- Harriet Tubman ›
- James John ›
- Ockley Green ›
- Peninsula ›
- Rosa Parks ›
- Sabin ›
- Sitton ›
- Vernon ›

Superintendent's recommendation · Northeast region

Northeast (Grant / McDaniel) region

The Northeast Region phases its changes over two years. In 2027–28, Beverly Cleary K–5 students join Irvington in the Irvington building. Beverly Cleary 6-8 Intensive Skills Center (ISC) students move to either Tubman or Beaumont, based on their neighborhood boundary. In 2028–29, the merged school community moves into the reopened Beverly Cleary building and the Irvington building closes. Rose City Park also closes in 2028–29, and its students move to Scott and Vietnamese DLI moves to Vestal.

Beverly Cleary and Laurelhurst become K–5 in 2027–28, with middle-grade students going to Beaumont and Mt. Tabor.

Spanish DLI is consolidated at Rigler for K–5 and Roseway Heights for middle grades. In 2028–29, Vietnamese DLI moves from Rose City Park to Vestal.

Recommendation **2** schools close
Irvington · Rose City Park

Status quo/No change **0** schools close
No schools close and no boundaries change.

Projections for the **2031–32** school year

Measure	Recommendation	Status quo/No change
Schools that would close	2	**0**

Schools above the sustainability threshold	62%	**40%**
Students attending a school above the threshold	76%	**59%**
Students Experiencing Poverty in Sustainable Schools	76%	**53%**
Historically Underserved Students in Sustainable Schools	80%	**57%**
Students Receiving Special Education Services in Sustainable Schools	74%	**57%**
Multilingual Learners in Sustainable Schools	80%	**48%**

Sustainability thresholds **K–5:** 360 students **K–8 and middle school:** 500 students **High school:** 1,100 students

What changes and when under the recommendation

Read each line as **school** → where students go. Special education changes are noted only where students would attend a different school than their general education peers.

2027–28 school year

Closures

Irvington K–5 closes; receives Beverly Cleary K–5 students in 2027–28, then moves to Beverly Cleary in 2028–29

Grade levels & feeders

Beverly Cleary becomes K–5 · 6–8 → Beaumont, ISC students → Tubman or Beaumont.

Laurelhurst becomes K–5 · 6–8 → Mt. Tabor

Program moves

Rigler becomes K–5 Spanish DLI hub · from Scott K–5

Roseway Heights hosts middle-grade Spanish DLI · from Beaumont Middle School

2028–29 school year

Closures

Rose City Park → Scott

Irvington building closes; students move to the reopened Beverly Cleary building

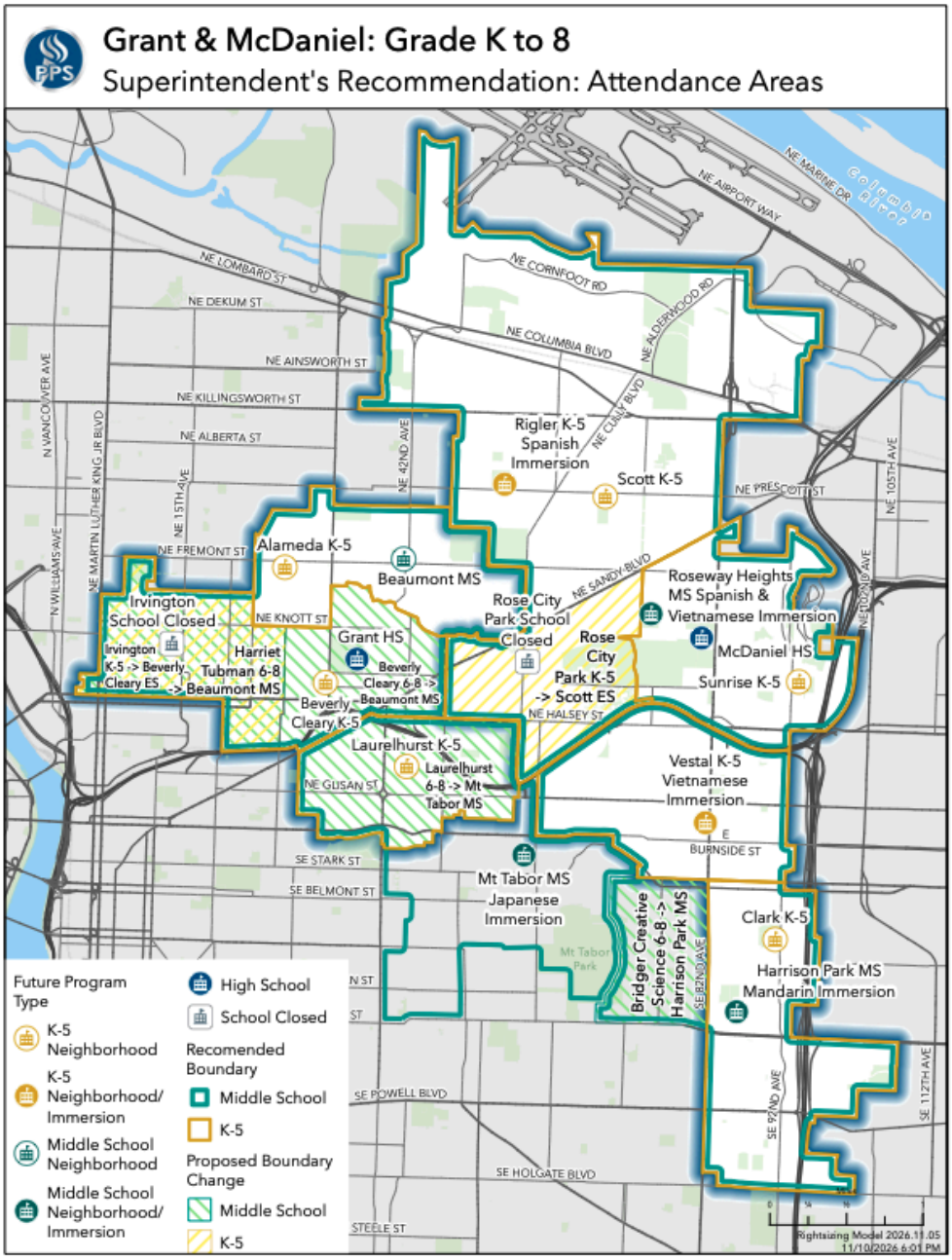
Grade levels & feeders

No grade levels & feeders in 2028–29

Program moves

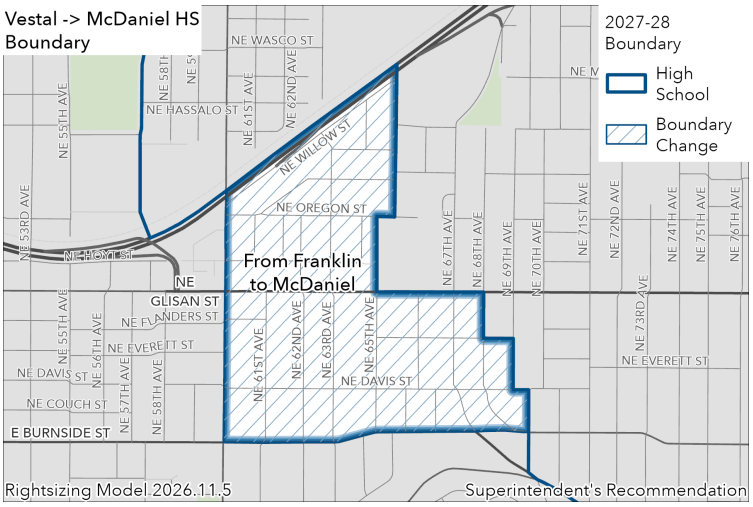
Vietnamese DLI Rose City Park → Vestal

Northeast Region Map of Proposed Changes



Northeast Region High School Boundary Changes

A boundary change between Franklin and McDaniel is proposed to align K-12 feeder patterns. This area was moved from Glencoe/Mt. Tabor to Vestal/Harrison Park in 2023.



Individual school impact reports

See the school level impact reports for descriptions of proposed changes and impacts. Select a school to go to its report in the attachments.

- Beaumont ›
- Beverly Cleary ›
- Harrison Park ›
- Irvington ›
- Laurelhurst ›
- Rigler ›
- Rose City Park ›
- Roseway Heights ›
- Scott ›
- Vestal ›

Southeast (Cleveland / Franklin) region

In the Southeast Region, five buildings close over two years. In 2027–28, Buckman and Creston close. Buckman students move to Sunnyside Environmental or Abernethy depending on where they live, with the SES classrooms moving to Sunnyside. Creston students move to Atkinson, with its CRIS Deaf and Hard of Hearing program moving to Glencoe.

In 2028–29, Lewis, Marysville and Woodmere close, and their students move to Duniway, Arleta and Whitman. A Duniway boundary change also moves students west of McLoughlin Boulevard to Llewellyn. Students in the Woodmere Communication Behavior (CB) classrooms will either move to a CB at Kelly or join their general education peers at Whitman. This will be determined on a case-by-case basis.

Sunnyside Environmental and Bridger become K–5, and several feeder patterns to middle and high schools are updated. Lent becomes the K–5 Spanish DLI hub, and Mandarin Chinese DLI moves from Clark to Woodstock.

Recommendation **5** schools close
Buckman · Creston · Lewis · Marysville · Woodmere

Status quo/No change **0** schools close
No schools close and no boundaries change.

Projections for the **2031–32** school year

Measure	Recommendation	Status quo/No change
Schools that would close	5	**0**
Schools above the sustainability threshold	59%	**19%**
Students attending a school above the threshold	73%	**38%**
Students Experiencing Poverty in Sustainable Schools	68%	**36%**
Historically Underserved Students in Sustainable Schools	65%	**37%**
Students Receiving Special Education Services in Sustainable Schools	69%	**30%**
Multilingual Learners in Sustainable Schools	65%	**43%**

Sustainability thresholds **K–5:** 360 students **K–8 and middle school:** 500 students **High school:** 1,100 students

What changes and when under the recommendation

Read each line as **school** → where students go. Special education changes are noted only where students would attend a different school than their general education peers.

2027–28 school year

Closures

Buckman → Sunnyside K–5 or Abernethy K-5; SES classrooms → Sunnyside

Creston → Atkinson; CRIS Deaf and Hard of Hearing → Glencoe

Grade levels & feeders

Sunnyside Environmental becomes K–5 (neighborhood and focus) · 6–8 → Hosford Middle School

Mt. Tabor receives students from Laurelhurst

Atkinson feeds to Kellogg Middle School

Program moves

Lent becomes K–5 Spanish DLI hub · from Atkinson

2028–29 school year

Closures

Lewis → Duniway

Marysville → Arleta

Woodmere → Whitman; CB students to Whitman or Kelly

Note: *Duniway boundary change: students west of McLoughlin Blvd. move to Llewellyn.*

Grade levels & feeders

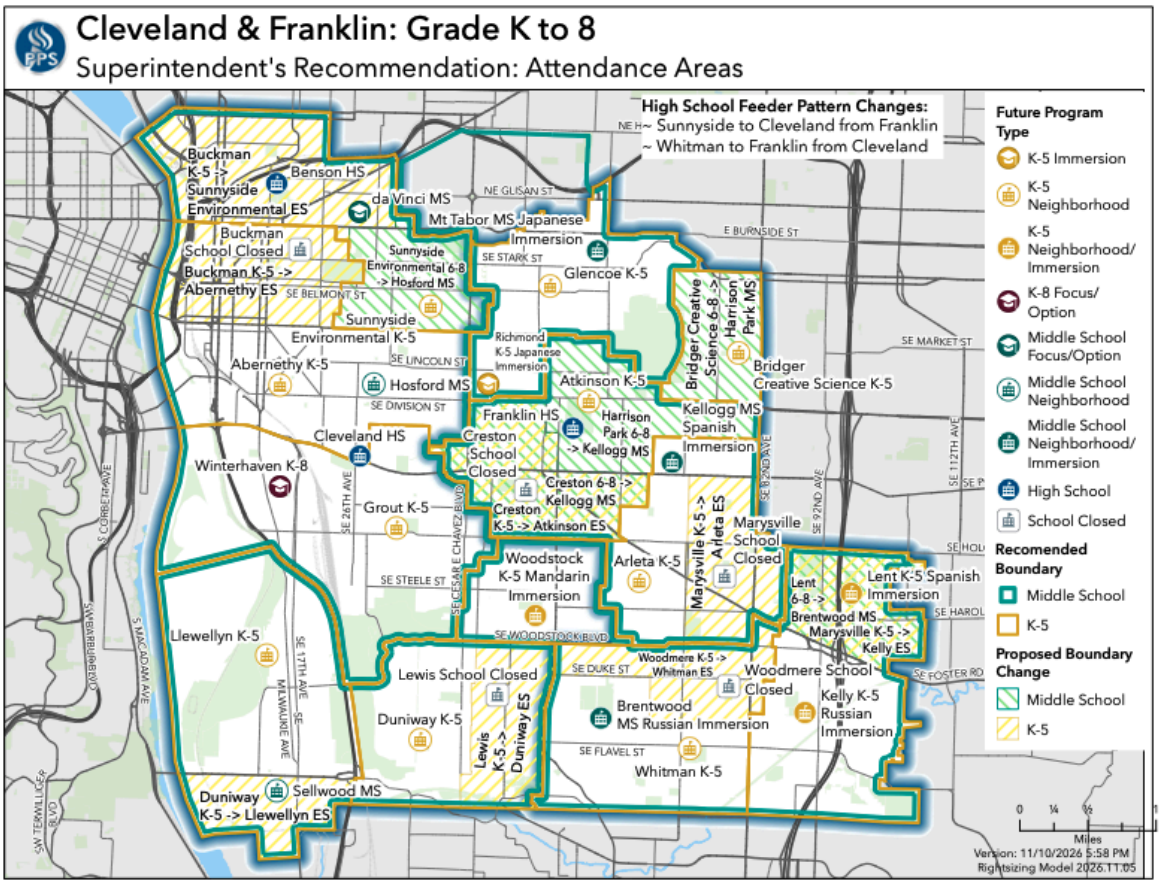
Bridger becomes K–5 (neighborhood and focus) · 6–8 → Harrison Park Middle School

Whitman K–5 neighborhood feeds to Franklin High School

Program moves

Mandarin Chinese DLI Clark → Woodstock

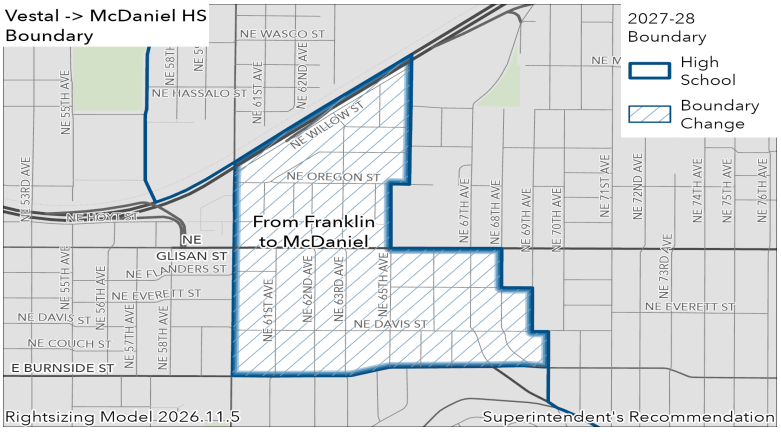
Southeast Region Map of Proposed Changes



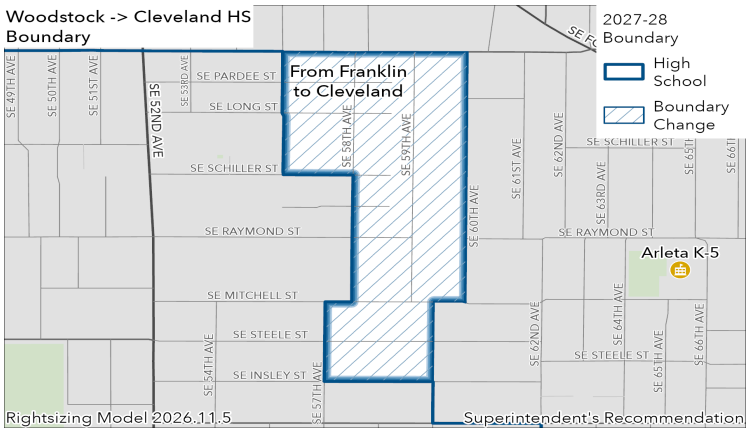
Southeast Region High School Boundary Changes

Four boundary changes are proposed to begin in 2027-28 to align K-12 feeder patterns:

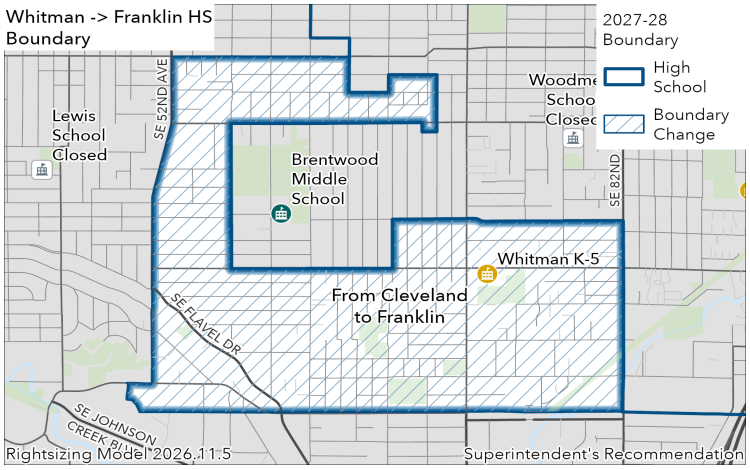
A portion of the Vestal area will move from Franklin to McDaniel. This area was moved from Glencoe/Mt. Tabor to Vestal/Harrison Park in 2023.



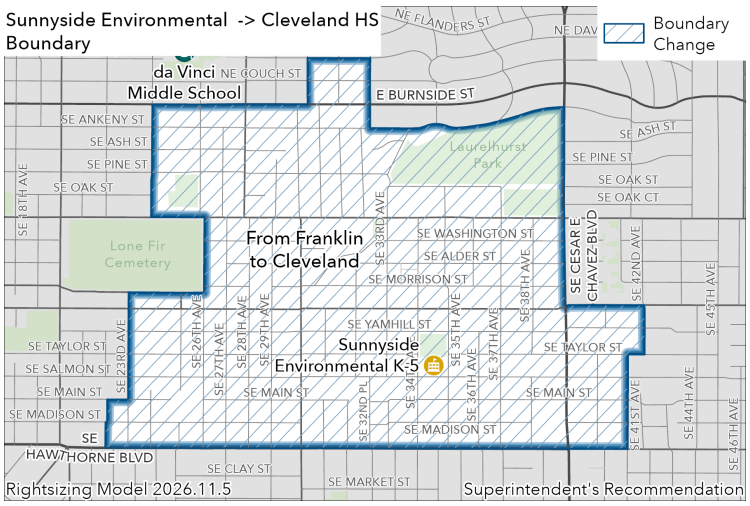
A portion of the Woodstock area will move from Franklin to Cleveland. This area was moved from Arleta/Kellogg to Woodstock/Brentwood in 2023.



The Whitman area will now go to Franklin instead of Cleveland.



The Sunnyside area will now go to Cleveland instead of Franklin.



Individual School Impact Reports

See the school level impact reports for descriptions of proposed changes and impacts. Select a school to go to its report in the attachments.

- Abernethy ›
- Arleta ›
- Atkinson ›
- Brentwood ›
- Bridger Creative Science ›
- Buckman ›
- Creston ›
- Duniway ›
- Hosford ›
- Kellogg ›
- Kelly ›
- Lent ›
- Lewis ›
- Marysville ›
- Sunnyside ›
- Whitman ›
- Woodmere ›

Superintendent's recommendation · West region

West (Wells / Lincoln) region

In the West Region, there is a grade level change and a program move. In 2027–28, Metropolitan Learning Center becomes a K–8 school, and its 9–12 students would transition to Alliance High School, attend a focus option or return to their designated neighborhood high schools. In 2028–29, Odyssey K–8 moves to Forest Park, where the two schools will be co-located.

Recommendation **0** schools close
No schools close in this region.

Status quo/No change **0** schools close
No schools close and no boundaries change.

Projections for the **2031–32** school year

Measure	Recommendation	Status quo/No change
Schools that would close	0	**0**
Schools above the sustainability threshold	35%	**35%**
Students attending a school above the threshold	62%	**62%**
Students Experiencing Poverty in Sustainable Schools	53%	**53%**

Historically Underserved Students in Sustainable Schools	62%	**62%**
Students Receiving Special Education Services in Sustainable Schools	54%	**54%**
Multilingual Learners in Sustainable Schools	58%	**58%**

Sustainability thresholds **K–5:** 360 students **K–8 and middle school:** 500 students **High school:** 1,100 students

What changes and when under the recommendation

Read each line as **school** → where students go. Special education changes are noted only where students would attend a different school than their general education peers.

2027–28 school year

Grade levels & feeders

Metropolitan Learning Center becomes K–8 · 9–12 → Alliance High School or an alternative school, a focus option, or return to neighborhood high school

Program moves

No program moves in 2027–28

2028–29 school year

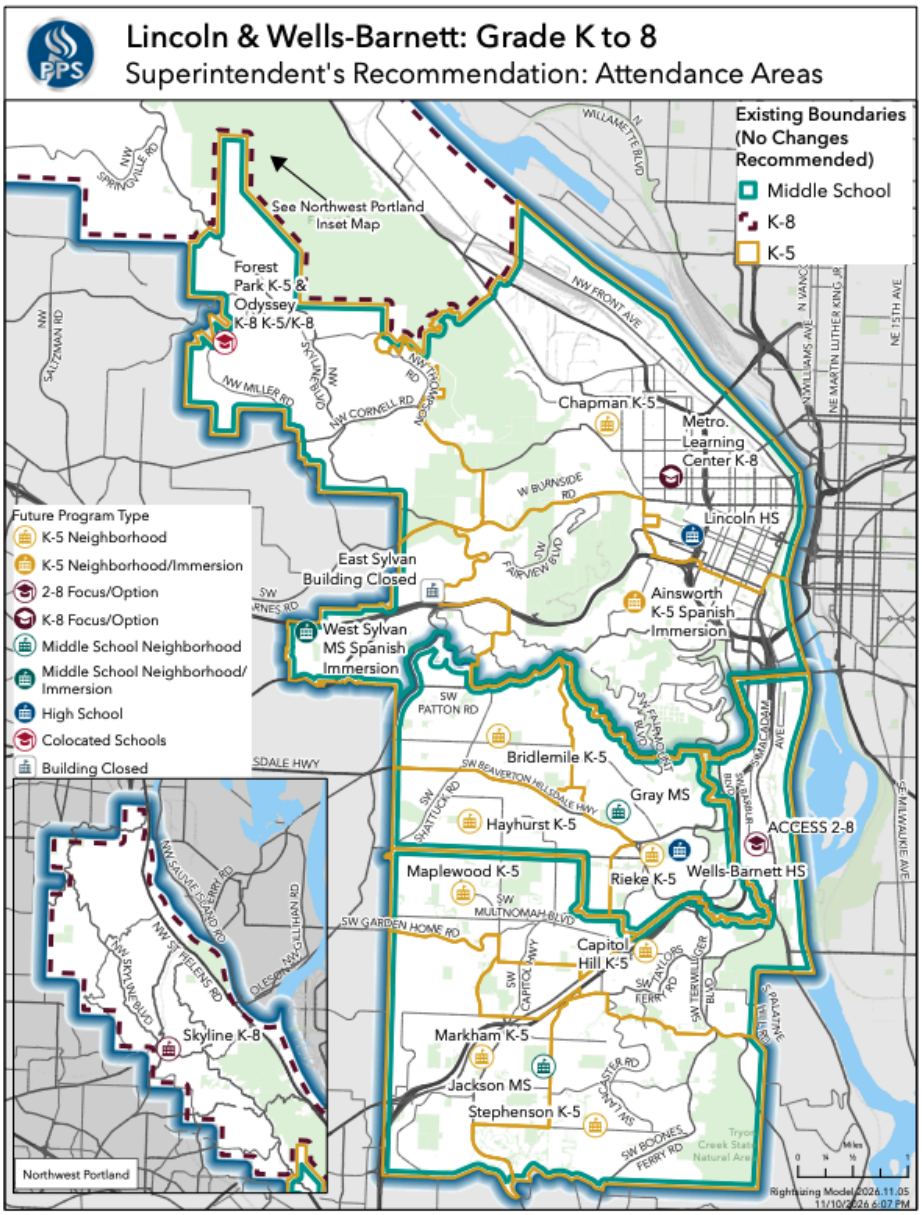
Grade levels & feeders

No grade levels & feeders in 2028–29

Program moves

Odyssey K–8 → Forest Park · co-located

West Region Map of Proposed Changes - No Changes Proposed



Individual School Impact Reports

See the school level impact reports for additional changes at each school. Select a school to go to its report in the attachments.

MLC ›

Odyssey and Forest Park ›

Analysis

The recommended actions put PPS on a path to stabilizing elementaries across our system and increasing the number of students who experience rich learning environments. As outlined above, should the board approve these actions, PPS teams will move into the next phase of work and initiate school specific engagement and planning to support students, staff and families making transitions as soon as the fall of 2027.

We summarize the impacts through our key performance indicators and the guiding principles adopted by the board. We will look at each of the three categories of indicators to highlight where the recommendation improves the student experience as well as places where intentional action will be needed to mitigate the impacts on our most vulnerable students and communities. More detailed information about each indicator and their connection to board policy and the guiding principles can be found in the attachments which includes Rightsizing Key Performance Indicators.

Opportunity and Stability Key Performance Indicators

As noted previously, the focus of these changes has been on schools and sites that serve students in kindergarten through eighth grade. We report the impacts of the proposed changes on these specific grade levels. While the changes are initiated in the fall of 2027, the analysis looks ahead to the 2031-32 school year when all of the changes have been enacted. We will monitor the schools that were reconfigured from K-8, Spanish dual language immersion hubs, and schools that experienced a significant amount of change.

Schools Above the Threshold

Opportunity and Stability				
Description	Analysis Metrics	Grade Level	Recommendation 2031-32	No Change 2031-32
Do students have access to stable, comparable learning environments across our district?	Percent of schools at a grade level with enrollment above threshold (e.g % of K-5 schools with enrollment > 360)	K-5	50%	18%
		K-8	0%	15%
		6-8	47%	13%

As seen in the table above:

- 50% of the 42 elementaries will have enrollments that are above our enrollment floor of 360 students which helps to stabilize the system overall and is an improvement of 32% over no changes.
- While this strengthens the PPS system overall there are still four schools (James John, Maplewood, Sitton, and Sunrise) with very low enrollment (less than 260 students) which we will monitor closely to

ensure students are receiving comparable academic programming to their peers. Stephenson is just above at 261

- Similarly, 47% of the 15 middle schools have enrollment above the enrollment floor of 500 students, a 34% improvement when compared to the status quo (no changes).
- For middle grades, Hosford, Robert Gray and Sellwood have projected enrollment of below 400 students and will need to be monitored closely.
- The majority of K-8 schools are reconfigured to elementaries, the remaining K-8s include ACCESS Academy, Astor, Metropolitan Learning Center, Odyssey Program, Skyline and Winterhaven. They all have enrollment less than 500.

Focal Students in Schools Above the Threshold

Opportunity and Stability				
Description	Analysis Metrics	Grade Level	Recommendation 2031-32	No Change 2031-32
Do students have access to stable, comparable learning environments across our district?	Percent of focal students enrolled in schools above the threshold	K-5 Poverty	59%	20%
		K-5 SPED	59%	21%
		K-5 MLL	68%	29%
		K-5 Underserved by Race	60%	21%
		K-8 Poverty	0%	29%
		K-8 SPED	0%	21%
		K-8 MLL	0%	32%
		K-8 Underserved by Race	0%	30%
		6-8 Poverty	57%	11%
		6-8 SPED	54%	15%
		6-8 MLL	64%	11%
		6-8 Underserved by Race	62%	13%

As seen in the table above:

- More focal students in every group are enrolled in sustainable schools, increasing the likelihood of consistent programming and educators with the largest gains for multilingual learners in middle schools and in elementaries for students experiencing poverty and historically underserved by race.
- No K-8 schools enroll enough students to meet the enrollment threshold. We will continue to monitor our K-8 schools to ensure that students have access to comparable programming as their peers.

Range of Enrollment by Grade Band

Opportunity and Stability				
Description	Analysis Metrics	Grade Level	Recommendation 2031-32	No Change 2031-32
Do students have access to stable, comparable learning environments across our district?	Range of enrollment (largest - smallest school) by grade configuration	K-5	345 (MLK Jr. - Sitton)	389 (Ainsworth - Rosa Parks)
		K-8	270 (Astor - MLC)	425 (Faubion - Skyline)
		6-8	304 (Roseway Heights - Sellwood)	270 (West Sylvan - Sellwood)

There is no significant improvement in the relative size of the schools in each grade band. We will continue to monitor both our largest and smallest schools to ensure that students have comparable educational experiences.

Physical Environment and Pathways Key Performance Indicators

Efficiently Used Schools by Grade Band

Physical Environment and Pathways				
Description	Analysis Metrics	Grade Level	Recommendation 2031-32	No Change 2031-32
Are we using school spaces to support academic programming and sustainability?	Percent of efficiently utilized schools in grade band with utilization between 70- 100%?	K-5	43%	22%
		K-8	17%	54%
		6-8	27%	0%

There are gains for both elementary and middle schools. We still have the opportunity to improve the match between our school site physical plant and students accessing academic programming. For middle schools this is due to declining enrollment so schools have excess capacity. For K-8s it is due to having more students that were designed for the building to accommodate.

Students Within 1.0 and 1.5 Miles

Physical Environment and Pathways

Description	Analysis Metrics	Grade Level	Recommendation 2031-32	No Change 2031-32
Are school boundaries compact allowing students to have safe routes to school?	Percent of students living within 1.0 and 1.5 miles of school	K-5	58% / 80%	65% / 81%
		K-8	68% / 78%	78% / 84%
		6-8	29% / 50%	30% / 50%

For elementary schools there is a 7% decrease in the number of students who live within walking distance of their school. The individual impacted school reports show the estimated number of bus routes for each site in the coming year should the recommended changes be approved by the board of education. For middle schools, the percentage of middle school students who would be eligible for transportation to their neighborhood school remains the same although which students are eligible may change.

Schools With Split Feeders

Physical Environment and Pathways					
Description	Analysis Metrics	Grade Level	Recommendation 2031-32	No Change 2031-32	Baseline 2025-26
Are students able to continue together from one grade level to the next?	Number of schools that split to feeder multiple schools at the next grade level	K-5	3 Bridlemile, Vestal Woodstock	3 Bridlemile, Atkinson, Woodstock	3 Bridlemile, Atkinson, Woodstock
		K-8	0	2 Sunnyside, Bridger	2 Sunnyside, Bridger
		6-8	3 Mt. Tabor, Harrison Park, Brentwood	7 Beaumont, Harriet Tubman, Harrison Park, Hosford, Brentwood. Mt. Tabor, Ockley Green	7 Beaumont, Harriet Tubman, Harrison Park, Hosford, Brentwood. Mt. Tabor, Ockley Green

One of the central considerations was to increase the opportunity for students to move together with their peers as they progress from one grade level to the next. We were able to reduce the total number of middle schools that send students to multiple high schools, except in the southeast.

Balance and Impact Key Performance Indicators

Focal Students Who Move Due to Changes

Balance and Impact - Superintendent's Recommendation				
Description	Analysis Metrics	Student who move	2031-32 Number	2031-32 Percent
Who moves as a result of these changes? Are the impacts similar across student groups?	Percent of focal students who will move in grades K through 8 (This includes students who move programs but stay at same school)	All students experiencing a move	5641	19.0%
		Students who are experiencing poverty	2072	21.4%
		Students on IEPs	1133	20.0%
		Multi-lingual students who move	861	26.5%
		Historically Underserved by race students who move	2264	21.7%

The changes outlined in this recommendation over the next two years will impact students across our system. The table above shows the total number of students enrolled in grades K-8 who may move to a new school site. We heard from families and educators that they were concerned about the number of students and staff that would experience a change in a single given year. The recommendation phases the changes over a two-year period specifically to address this concern and to mitigate the impacts on students who were in schools impacted by recent enrollment balancing or program changes. We will discuss this in more detail in the equity impact statement, which reflects who bears the burden of changes which are felt cumulatively over time. Overall, a greater percentage of our focal students compared to the overall population will experience a change with multi-lingual learners moving the most. We have heard from many families that the access to more stable schools may not be worth the cost of community disruption. We also recognize that trust is low and that these changes will require sustained attention, communication, and support over multiple years.

Title I School Students Who Move Due to Changes

Balance and Impact -Superintendent's Recommendation			
Description	Analysis Metrics	Recommendation 2031-32 Number	Recommendation 2031-32 Percent
Who is impacted by the changes? Which communities benefit and which are burdened?	Number of Title I schools students will move from	15 out of 32	47%
	Number of Title I schools students will move to	17 out of 28	61%
	Number of non-Title I schools students will move from	18 out of 50	36%

	Number of non-Title I schools students will move to	18 out of 44	41%

Historically Title I schools have borne the brunt of school closures. PPS tracked which TItle I schools were impacted by school closures as well as which schools received students. Some mergers have two Title I schools coming together, such as Whitman and Woodmere, others have a non-Title I and a Title I school merging such as Sabin and Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr.

Regional Comparison: Recommendation Impact at the Elementary and Middle Grades

Opportunity and Stability Comparison at Elementary Grades

Elementary	District	North	Northeast	Southeast	West
% of Sustainable Schools	50%	50%	63%	64%	20%
% of Students in Sustainable Schools	61%	63%	73%	72%	29%
% of Students Living in Poverty in Sustainable Schools	59%	61%	68%	69%	18%
% Underserved Race	60%	64%	71%	59%	33%
% of Students Receiving Special Education Services	59%	57%	69%	70%	27%
% Multi-lingual Learners	68%	77%	75%	64%	33%

The changes outlined in this recommendation vary by region. Students and communities that are most impacted also benefit in the long run by being in sustainable schools with adequate resources. When we look only at the elementary grades, students in the west do not experience changes but neither will they be in sustainable schools. The vast majority of focal students in the north will be learning in schools where the enrollment has stable and sustainable resources. This means that we will need to pay close attention to enrollment patterns in the west.

Opportunity and Stability Comparison at Middle Grades

Middle	District	North	Northeast	Southeast	West
% of Sustainable Schools	47%	67%	33%	40%	67%
% of Students in Sustainable Schools	55%	72%	42%	49%	76%
% of Students Living in Poverty in Sustainable Schools	57%	78%	55%	39%	75%

% Underserved Race	62%	76%	59%	46%	78%
% of Students Receiving Special Education Services	54%	80%	43%	41%	74%
% Multi-lingual Learners	64%	90%	61%	38%	76%

We are expecting sharp declines in middle school enrollment over the next five years. There are fewer middle schools on the west side (three), they tend to be larger and more stable. The change in the north, if they are adopted, would lead to more stable and sustainable middle schools primarily due to grade level reconfigurations. In the coming years we will need to monitor middle school enrollment and particularly in the northeast and southeast regions.

Equity Impact Statement

Making no changes leaves less than 20% of PPS schools above a sustainable threshold. (See Schools Above the Threshold table above). The final recommendation more than doubles that for every focal group in elementary and middle schools (see Focal Students Above the Threshold table above). Of the three scenarios, the final recommendation provides significant gains for focal students while closing the fewest schools, no changes does far less for them than the final recommendation while closing none.

While there are benefits for students with this change, there is also the burden of managing change and the grief that comes with disrupting communities. Multilingual learners carry more of this change than any other group (see Focal Students Who Move Due to Changes table above) while also moving to more stable school sites (see Focal Students in Schools Above the Threshold table abovec). While multilingual learners are overrepresented in the percentage of students who move, they ultimately end up as the highest percentage of students in sustainable schools overall. As enrollment grows at receiving schools, the total number of students receiving special education services may rise—but in most cases, their overall share of the student body remains steady.

The Ida B. Wells/Lincoln region contributes no closures and has the fewest schools at sustainable enrollment levels.

The families least represented in the community feedback are the families most affected by the largest program change in the package. Multilingual families are about one in eight students and about one in 50 survey respondents.

The recommendation advances educational equity relative to the status quo for every focal student group, by a substantial margin. It does not distribute the burden of change evenly. As we move into future years and implementation, if this recommendation is adopted, then we will need to continue to look back to ask if the disruption has provided sufficient benefits for the populations impacted.

We recognize that this disruption is significant for all students. We commit to adding a field in Synergy for students who are moved because of this recommendation and providing future analysis of academic and

attendance impacts with this disaggregation. The analysis supports moving forward on the condition that the commitments are funded, owned and monitored rather than described.

Without those commitments, this is an enrollment plan with an equity result. With them, it is an equity plan.

Financial Impact Rationale

The primary financial benefit of consolidating shrinking schools and programs is to align physical facility capacity and annual operating costs with projected student enrollment, allowing the district to concentrate limited operational resources in fewer, fully resourced campuses. Combining school communities eliminates duplicative school-level administrative overhead, improves overall district building utilization, and stabilizes enrollment-based staffing models.

While initial one-time transition expenses—including equipment relocation, receiving school facility adjustments, and ongoing minimum building security/utility maintenance—will be incurred during implementation, the consolidation produces substantial net recurring savings. These net annual savings are directly reinvested into receiving campuses, transportation costs, and transition supports.

Below is a table with school by school details regarding net savings. These numbers are projections for enrollment and 2027-28 current service level staffing and operations if there were no changes for comparative purposes.

Transportation changes generated net savings from closures (i.e. Buckman, Creston, Irvington, and Peninsula in year 1). Costs estimates to move buildings, programs, and grade reconfigurations include staff costs. Facility upgrades listed below are general fund expenses that are not applicable to the bond. Also, some costs may not be reflected as we need to undergo design. (i.e. putting up walls, etc.).

Estimated Net Savings by School

School	Projected FY28 costs at current staffing levels*	Projected FY28 overall savings, including impact on other schools	Potential transport costs (savings)	Facility upgrades at receiving school	Operations (security + minimum utilities)	Moving equipment, furniture, materials	Remaining to reinvest	5% contingency
Year 1 · 2027–28 closures								
Beach	4,883,769	957,658	105,026	3,100	29,475	200,000	620,057	31,003
Buckman	5,295,940	934,719	-50,326	41,400	28,984	200,000	714,661	35,733
Creston	5,958,144	1,085,010	-17,204	6,800	32,999	200,000	862,415	43,121
Irvington	4,097,714	899,830	-49,039	30,100	24,361	200,000	694,408	34,720
Peninsula	5,004,615	961,959	-169,511	3,100	27,564	200,000	900,806	45,040
Sabin	4,895,684	898,472	25,716	3,100	25,751	200,000	643,905	32,195

Program Moves						540,000		
Grade Reconfiguration						420,000		
Year 1 Totals	**30,135,866**	**5,737,648**	**-155,338**	**87,600**	**169,134**	**2,160,000**	**4,436,252**	**221,813**
Year 2 · 2028–29 closures								
East Sylvan (Odyssey)	3,205,413	418,509	0	30,100	16,175	200,000	172,234	8,612
Lewis	3,933,404	860,366	122,707	83,000	26,023	200,000	428,636	21,432
Marysville	6,283,380	1,180,128	128,624	30,100	28,756	200,000	792,648	39,632
Rose City Park	5,971,122	883,254	126,185	27,000	28,920	200,000	501,149	25,057
Woodmere	5,150,541	1,100,925	112,707	3,100	26,754	200,000	758,364	37,918
Program Moves						60,000		
Grade Reconfiguration						60,000		
Year 2 Totals	**24,543,860**	**4,443,182**	**490,223**	**173,300**	**126,628**	**1,060,000**	**2,653,031**	**132,652**
Cumulative Totals	**$54,679,726**	**$10,180,830**	**$334,885**	**$260,900**	**$295,762**	**$3,220,000**	**$7,089,283**	**$354,464**

*All figures in dollars. Negative transport figures are savings. * [Footnote text for projected FY28 costs at current staffing levels]*

Projected School Staffing: No Change/Status Quo vs. Recommendation (2027–28)

Methodology & Important Caveats

The school-level projections in this section are **preliminary planning estimates** and will be updated following the release of Portland State University's revised enrollment forecasts in January. These figures are intended strictly for comparative modeling and should not be interpreted as final school staffing allocations.

To provide an apples-to-apples comparison, both scenarios model the impact of applying identical baseline reduction criteria across the district, reflecting a gross systemwide reduction of 277.5 FTE under the status quo and 308.5 FTE under the final recommendation before add-backs and reinvestments are applied. The stated target is 223 FTE to address our projected $65 million budget deficit. Both items are over reduced to allow for the opportunity for some reinvestment. Both scenarios require an additional 20 - 30 FTE for program balancing for unforeseen issues that arise in the spring and fall.

How Systemwide Reductions Are Modeled

The table below breaks down how the district reaches its required budget savings across the status quo and the final recommendation. Rather than representing arbitrary cuts, the model illustrates how consolidating

under-enrolled sites unlocks structural efficiencies, allowing the district to protect core classroom instruction and reinvest directly into student programs. In both models, class size ratios in all grades remain the same, including blended classrooms in grades 1 and 2 as well as grades 4 and 5. In order to achieve the necessary savings significant reductions are necessary and they fall into three categories:

- Enrollment & Recommendation Reductions
    - Enrollment (-40.4 FTE): Reflects standard staffing adjustments tied to projected districtwide enrollment decline across both models.
    - Scenario Consolidation (~-75 FTE): Under the status quo, the district captures 0 FTE in structural savings because it continues operating the same number of school buildings. By consolidating under-enrolled sites, the final recommendation captures about 75 FTE in programmatic efficiencies and shifts 10.5 FTE in Principal and Administrative Assistant positions into direct building operational savings as well as 8.5 FTE back to Title 1 K-5 receiving schools to work towards less blends in those schools
- Class Size Ratios
    - Class Size ratios were not adjusted in either Status Quo nor in the recommendation.
    - Blends were not adjusted in either the Status Quo nor in the recommendation, except potentially in the case of middle grades students in K-8s and neighborhood/DLI blends in co-located programs.

Receiving School Reinvestment (15–20 FTE): Out of the 22 FTE in programmatic reinvestment unlocked by the Recommendation, 15 to 20 FTE is reserved specifically to reinvest in schools welcoming students from consolidated sites, supporting smooth student transitions, manageable class sizes, and expanded opportunities.

School-by-School Staffing Projections (2027–28)

The staffing table below is for modeling purposes only. Enrollment projections will change as we move through the Fall and Winter. The FTE represented below does not include FTE for Special Education services, multilingual services, Title 1 nor Measure 98. The weighted class size averages add equity funding into Homeroom classes in this model, but could be allocated differently depending on principal and community needs. Weighted average class size takes into account teacher planning time and will in most cases be higher than actuals when other funding sources are added in.

Modeling School-by-School Staffing Projections (2027–28)

*Color Key: Yellow = 2026–27 Current Baseline | Green = 2027–28 Final Recommendation | Pink = 2027–28 status quo/no changes. * Average weighted class size. ** Average weighted class size including equity FTE (recommendation: equity FTE applied to homerooms). † FTE with reductions for status quo/no changes. ‡ FTE with all reductions in the recommendation. Reinvestments are not included in this table. — = no 2027–28 figures (school closes).*

	2026–27 baseline		2027–28 status quo		2027–28 recommendation		
School	FTE	Class size with equity**	FTE†	Class size with equity**	Projected enrollment	FTE‡	Class size with equity**
ACCESS	19.55	26.3	16.75	28.2	310	16.75	28.2

School	2026–27 baseline		2027–28 status quo		2027–28 recommendation		
	FTE	Class size with equity**	FTE†	Class size with equity**	Projected enrollment	FTE‡	Class size with equity**
Abernethy	16.95	22.8	14.15	24.2	312	15.55	28.4
Ainsworth	31.85	25.2	27.35	27.8	555	27.25	27.8
Alameda	25.75	28.0	23.95	27.7	499	23.95	27.7
Arleta	16.45	20.6	13.45	22.6	215	13.45	22.6
Astor	27.95	23.5	23.15	26.7	424	24.75	25.6
Atkinson	22.75	22.4	20.15	24.2	474	23.75	26.3
Beach	21.75	21.2	16.05	24.7	—	—	—
Beaumont	25.05	31.1	22.35	32.1	520	26.45	33.7
Benson	62.5	29.1	65.75	29.1	1200	65.75	29.1
Beverly Cleary	29.35	24.5	22.75	28.7	501	23.95	27.8
Boise-Eliot/Humboldt	21.03	22.6	19.45	22.0	319	19.35	22.0
Brentwood	28.35	31.1	23.35	30.9	422	24.65	29.5
Bridger Creative Science	29.35	23.6	25.15	26.3	450	25.15	26.3
Bridlemile	23.65	25.0	20.65	26.7	414	20.65	26.7
Buckman	17.95	22.0	15.85	21.2	—	—	—
Capitol Hill	18.15	26.7	16.55	25.8	310	16.55	25.8
Chapman	22.63	23.4	17.55	24.3	316	17.55	24.3
Chief Joseph	16.75	23.0	14.65	23.3	440	22.75	25.9
Clark	27.73	19.4	20.65	23.2	361	20.55	23.3
Cleveland	76	30.6	76.00	30.7	1465	76	30.8
Creston	13.25	26.4	13.25	21.2	—	—	—
César Chávez	35.75	18.4	26.55	22.6	414	23.05	23.7
Duniway	19.55	27.9	16.55	28.2	338	16.55	28.2
Faubion	42.95	24.4	36.43	25.4	424	25.584	23.5
Forest Park	16.25	25.9	14.15	26.0	260	14.15	26.0
Franklin	94.33	29.0	90.83	29.2	1687	91.33	29.0
George	26.95	27.6	24.05	28.7	534	31.55	28.5
Glencoe	20.25	24.2	17.05	24.9	312	17.05	25.0
Grant	102	31.3	97.00	31.3	1938	97	31.3
Gray	25.15	32.0	23.35	32.0	427	22.85	32.8
Grout	21.03	23.4	16.55	25.3	305	16.55	25.4
Harriet Tubman	28.55	29.8	26.05	30.6	602	33.15	30.5
Harrison Park	29.35	28.9	24.85	29.6	407	23.65	29.7
Hayhurst	18.65	22.4	15.85	23.8	274	15.85	23.8
Hosford	29.65	31.6	26.25	31.2	601	31.65	31.6
Ida B. Wells-Barnett	81	30.8	78.50	30.8	1531	78.5	30.9
Irvington	17.25	23.9	14.65	22.9	—	—	—
Jackson	37.85	31.9	34.45	31.7	661	33.45	32.8
James John	26.29	20.6	20.65	23.2	289	16.55	24.1
Jefferson	36.67	25.9	44.17	23.9	570	44.67	23.8
Kellogg	32.75	29.4	28.65	30.2	572	31.45	30.3

School	2026–27 baseline		2027–28 status quo		2027–28 recommendation		
	FTE	Class size with equity**	FTE†	Class size with equity**	Projected enrollment	FTE‡	Class size with equity**
Kelly	28.23	21.7	22.15	23.8	404	22.15	23.8
Laurelhurst	33.35	26.4	30.90	28.7	376	18.05	28.9
Lent	18.95	21.1	16.35	21.3	329	18.85	23.5
Lewis	16.45	23.0	14.65	21.3	224	14.65	21.3
Lincoln	85	31.5	80.50	31.3	1603	81.5	31.4
Llewellyn	20.25	24.6	17.05	25.0	312	17.05	25.0
MLK Jr	23.19	21.0	20.95	21.1	572	33.45	22.4
Maplewood	18.65	25.0	16.35	23.2	278	16.35	23.2
Markham	21.25	24.1	17.55	24.0	312	17.55	24.0
Marysville	22.19	21.9	17.55	23.1	300	17.55	23.1
McDaniel	91.33	28.2	85.33	28.3	1535	85.83	28.2
Metro. Learning Center	21.05	18.9	18.95	20.5	210	15.95	20.3
Mt Tabor	24.05	33.0	21.65	33.0	642	32.65	32.8
Ockley Green	28.25	29.6	24.95	30.5	624	33.55	30.7
Odyssey	15.55	24.4	13.35	25.7	220	13.15	25.7
Peninsula	17.25	24.1	14.65	23.8	—	0	—
Richmond	25.75	28.1	23.95	28.0	504	23.95	28.0
Rieke	16.95	23.2	15.35	22.9	252	15.35	22.9
Rigler	21.03	23.9	17.55	23.5	487	26.55	23.8
Roosevelt	80.25	28.0	75.25	28.0	1314	75.25	28.0
Rosa Parks	15.19	20.1	11.75	19.9	480	27.05	22.9
Rose City Park	25.85	21.9	20.15	26.1	391	20.05	26.1
Roseway Heights	34.15	29.8	30.45	30.3	638	35.35	29.7
Sabin	16.45	24.6	14.65	22.5	—	0	—
Scott	35.23	20.5	27.35	23.8	323	18.05	23.9
Sellwood	29.85	33.0	27.05	33.0	524	27.25	32.8
Sitton	26.09	19.4	19.45	23.0	268	16.35	22.3
Skyline	15.55	22.7	12.95	23.7	196	12.95	23.7
Stephenson	16.95	24.5	14.15	27.1	271	14.15	27.1
Sunnyside Environmental	28.85	26.3	26.25	27.0	480	23.75	27.1
Sunrise	18.83	25.5	13.95	24.5	245	13.95	24.5
Vernon	29.75	27.4	26.55	27.3	325	17.05	26.3
Vestal	21.03	22.3	17.55	22.8	296	17.55	22.8
West Sylvan	35.55	32.9	34.45	32.9	688	34.45	33.0
Whitman	16.75	19.6	14.95	18.7	206	14.95	18.7
Winterhaven	19.55	26.2	16.15	29.4	311	16.15	29.4
Woodlawn	22.63	22.9	17.55	23.4	304	17.55	23.4
Woodmere	17.95	20.0	15.15	20.4	224	15.15	20.4
Woodstock	22.45	22.6	19.45	23.7	343	19.45	23.7
da Vinci	26.45	31.0	24.05	31.0	430	24.05	31.0
Alliance	23.5	27.2	22.50	22.2	275	21.5	22.2

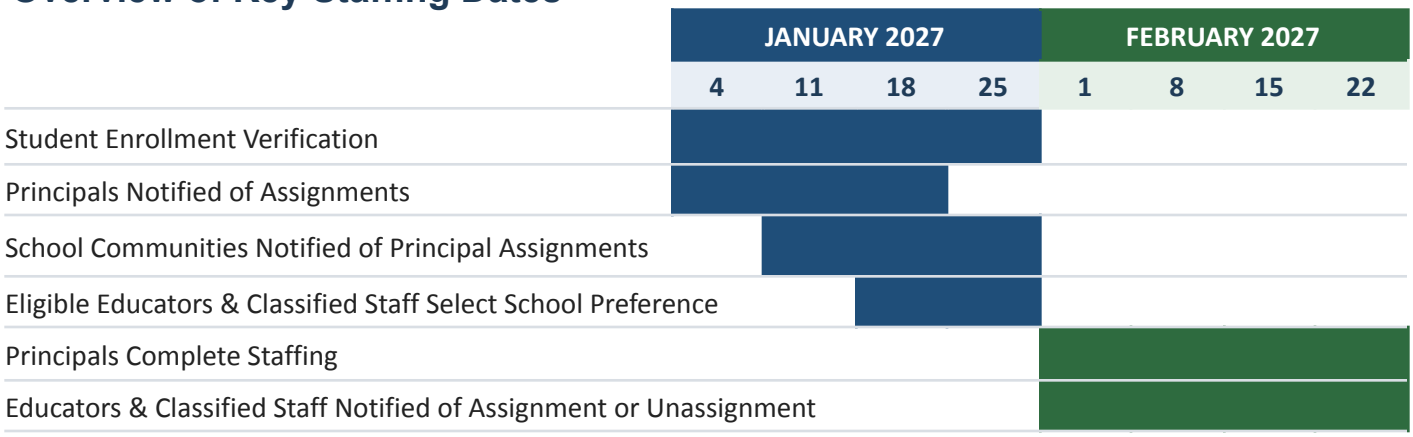
School	2026–27 baseline		2027–28 status quo		2027–28 recommendation		
	FTE	Class size with equity**	FTE†	Class size with equity**	Projected enrollment	FTE‡	Class size with equity**
Grand Total	2,464.53	27.1	2,197.01	27.1	39,369	2,155.51	27.4

Proportional Reinvestment for Receiving Schools (15–25 FTE)

If the Superintendent's recommendation is approved, the table below illustrates how a 15, or 20 FTE reinvestment pool would be distributed proportionally across receiving schools based on incoming student enrollment. These figures remain preliminary and subject to January enrollment updates.

School	Proportion of Total Received Students	Applied to 20 FTE	Applied to 15 FTE
Abernethy	2.24%	0.5	0.3
Astor	0.38%	0.1	0.1
Atkinson	6.20%	1.2	0.9
Beaumont	6.20%	1.2	0.9
Beverly Cleary	7.51%	1.5	1.1
César Chávez	6.45%	1.3	1
Chief Joseph	6.23%	1.2	1
George	4.57%	1	0.7
Harriet Tubman	5.56%	1.1	0.8
Hosford	4.86%	1	0.7
Kellogg	1.88%	0.4	0.3
Lent	2.33%	0.5	0.3
MLK Jr	7.51%	1.5	1.1
Mt Tabor	7.54%	1.5	1.1
Ockley Green	6.17%	1.2	1
Rigler	5.78%	1.2	1
Rosa Parks	10.26%	2	1.5
Roseway Heights	2.68%	0.5	0.4
Sunnyside Environmental	5.65%	1.1	0.8
Grand Total	**100.00%**	**20**	**15**

Overview of Key Staffing Dates



Dates subject to change

Transportation Impacts

PPS supports multiple ways for students to travel to school, including walking, biking, parent or family transportation, and PPS-provided school bus service for eligible students. Elementary students who live more than one mile from their neighborhood school and middle school students who live more than 1.5 miles from their neighborhood school are provided bus service. Other students may qualify based on Oregon Department of Education guidelines or individual needs. Bus stops and routes are planned around student proximity, safety, ride time, and anticipated ridership. Although PPS is not generally required to provide transportation to focus-option programs, including Dual Language Immersion (DLI), the district has prioritized access through a hub transportation model. This model connects students through designated regional pickup locations, supporting access for families across a broader geographic area, including the many native-speaking students these programs serve.

DLI students would have increased access to bus service through strategically designed regional hub routes, with estimated one-way route times averaging under 30 minutes for all languages except Japanese, on the east side of the river. Routes on the east side range from 18 minutes for regional routes to 43 minutes for west to east routes. Westside and Japanese routes average around 35 minutes with the longest route running 58 minutes. Overall, PPS-provided service is estimated to increase to 37 elementary school DLI routes and 29 middle school DLI routes. Efficiencies gained through consolidating and coordinating routes would offset some additional service needs, resulting in an estimated net annual transportation cost increase of $3 million. See attachment for more information.

Bus routes from this recommendation increase from 122 current routes to an estimated 153 routes. Currently there are more middle school routes than elementary, in the recommendation middle school routes exceed elementary routes. The cost for the additional 31 routes is estimated to be approximately $2.7 million.

Implementation Framework

The Rightsizing Implementation Framework guides how Portland Public Schools carries out the Board's Rightsizing decisions. It connects the district's commitments to students, families, and staff with the supported transitions and clear steps required to deliver on them.

The framework is centered on student wellbeing, belonging, and learning. It supports school communities through transition while the district expands student access to sustainable, well-resourced schools.

Purpose

The framework makes sure Rightsizing decisions are implemented with care, coherence, and accountability. Specifically, it:

- Translates Board decisions into action, defining what the district will do to support and transition impacted school communities for a successful start.
- Guides project planning, priorities, and governance, setting the structure needed to deliver the work.

While the framework informs a multiyear implementation plan, the initial scope focuses on the first year of implementation. The plan will continue to be built out, informed by lessons learned, to support schools transitioning in future years.

Structure

The framework is organized into five components, the essential elements of implementation. Together, they shape the plan to transition schools and establish the district supports needed to carry out the Board's final Rightsizing decisions:

- Successful Transitions
- Student Supports & Programming
- Enrollment & Transfer
- Staffing & Staff Supports
- Facilities & Operations

The framework is delivered through three layers of information, each designed for a different audience:

- Rightsizing Transition Guide – The primary public resource for staff, families, and the community, providing information to navigate a complex process and be ready for school and learning.
- School-specific and functional guides – More detailed information tailored to individual school communities and to specific areas of the work.
- Internal project management – The detailed technical information district teams need to carry out the work.

Each component has a designated workstream, with clear governance and accountability structures that set how the work is led, coordinated, and monitored.

Framework Components

Successful Transitions

Schools hold memories, friendships, traditions, and a sense of community. For many students, families, and staff, these changes will bring a sense of loss and uncertainty alongside hope for what comes next. Successful transitions start from that understanding. It is how PPS will support people through the transition, honor school communities, and help students feel safe, known, and connected in their new school.

This includes maintaining social emotional supports and trusted relationships for students, honoring each school's legacy and traditions, and creating opportunities for families, students, and staff to connect as a new community. Families, students, and staff will help shape this work, with school and district leads providing opportunities and supports for families to connect. District resources will include mental health supports, family information and events, joint gatherings such as school tours and PTA meetings, and preparation for school teams, all aimed at building belonging over time.

Student Supports and Programming

When schools merge or change, families want to know that learning, and the services their students rely on, will carry forward. In every PPS classroom, we aim to provide rigorous, high-quality learning experiences that are inclusive and joyful, and to disrupt racial inequities so every student has the opportunity to demonstrate excellence. Student Supports & Programming focuses on how PPS intends to maintain and strengthen that commitment through the transition.

This work spans the school day and beyond: general academics, social emotional learning, multilingual programs including Dual Language Immersion, Special Education, middle school transitions, early learning, curricular resources and libraries, and partnerships and programs such as SUN, childcare, and athletics. Initial plans for each area focus on continuity for students and clear information for families, and will be refined as school-level planning moves forward.

Enrollment and Transfer

The following are general enrollment and transfer options for students impacted by this recommendation, following the Student Assignment to Neighborhood Schools and Student Enrollment and Transfers policies. Please see the school impact summaries for specific guidance.

- Elementary school closures: K-4th grade students attending a school slated for closure will be assigned to a designated new school the following year. Students who transferred into the closing school also have the right to request a guaranteed transfer to their neighborhood schools.

- Dual language immersion program moves: K-4th grade students attending elementary school programs and 6-7th grade students attending middle school programs will be assigned to new program locations the following year. Students may also request guaranteed transfers back to their neighborhood school.
- K-8 grade reconfigurations: 5-7th grade students attending a school that is converting from a K-8 to a K-5 structure will be assigned to new middle schools the following year. Students who transferred into the closing grade levels also have the right to request a guaranteed transfer to their neighborhood schools.
- Boundary changes: PPS policy directs boundary changes to begin with students at entry grades: Kindergarten for elementary school, 6th grade for middle schools and 9th grade for high schools. Entry grade students who have siblings attending the former neighborhood school may receive guaranteed transfers to join their siblings. Students in other grades may remain in their current schools or request a guaranteed transfer to the new neighborhood school.
- All students have the right to request transfers to other schools. Details are available at pps.net/schoolchoice
    - The 2027-28 Middle and High school lottery application will open January 11, 2027
    - The 2027-28 Elementary and ACCESS Academy lottery application will open February 17, 2027.
    - The 2027-28 Hardship Petition Transfer application for all grades will be available beginning in April 2027. Families will use the hardship petition to request transfers back to their neighborhood schools and for other reasons including having siblings attend the same schools.
- To improve access to equitable opportunities, the following transfer changes will take effect in the 2027-28 school year, with application details available by February 2027:
    - Native speaking students applying to PPS dual language programs will be able to enroll directly through their regional program site instead of through the lottery

PPS students from families who experienced gentrification out of N/NE Portland neighborhoods may transfer back to schools in these areas, based on space availability.

Staffing and Staff Supports

Staffing and Staff Supports addresses how PPS will support employees through school closures, program moves, and grade reconfigurations. It focuses on mental health and employee supports, labor agreements and staffing processes, communication plans, and estimated timelines.

PPS recognizes that familiar educators, support staff, and administrators help students feel known, seen, and ready to learn. In collaboration with all labor partners, PPS will honor contractual obligations and applicable bargaining requirements as staffing transitions are planned and carried out, and will look for opportunities to keep familiar adults with students from each impacted community within those agreements.

Facilities and Operations

Facilities and Operations addresses how PPS will prepare receiving schools so students and staff are ready for learning. It coordinates moving and readiness across facility and operational areas, including technology,

transportation, security, nutrition services, and academic and shared spaces. School readiness plans guide space planning, facility improvements, and a timeline of what to expect.

It also includes a building closure and repurposing plan for schools that are closing. Support will continue after schools open to help with final adjustments.

Implementation Evaluation Plan

The Rightsizing Implementation Evaluation Plan will monitor, evaluate, and learn from PPS's Rightsizing and school transition process. A Culturally Responsive Evaluation (CRE) framework will actively involve impacted communities in contextualizing/interpreting outcomes and shaping recommendations.

The evaluation will be both formative and summative. Formative evaluation will be reported on a quarterly basis and will monitor progress in real time, showing the relationship between what we said vs. what has been done to date. These quarterly feedback loops will identify implementation bottlenecks, equity gaps, and operational friction early enough for course corrections.

A comprehensive end-of-year report will aggregate quarterly analyses to assess overall impact, measure progress against district commitments, and uphold public accountability to the Board, families, and community.

Evaluation Methods

The evaluation will utilize a mixed-methods design combining quantitative and qualitative data and analysis. Potential quantitative data under consideration includes attendance stability, enrollment retention, building walk-through data, and survey scales. Potential qualitative data sources include listening sessions and student focus group data.

All data will be disaggregated to ensure that rightsizing does not exacerbate systemic inequities.

Implementation Timeline

Planning Window	Major Activities & Milestones
December 2026 – January 2027	● Establish central office and school transition teams. ● Release initial transition guidance and communications. ● Begin student and family outreach.

Planning Window	Major Activities & Milestones
January – March 2027	● Develop school-specific transition plans. ● Assess cohort cohesion and individual student support needs. ● Communicate enrollment and transfer processes. ● Begin administrator and staff assignment processes. ● Plan receiving-school spaces, facility work, and moving services. ● Begin conducting school visits, open houses, community-building activities, and legacy events. ● Begin engagement and planning to repurpose buildings for closures.
March – June 2027	● Continue conducting school visits, open houses, community-building activities, and legacy events. ● Coordinate student service handoffs and staff collaboration. ● Communicate childcare and partnership arrangements as confirmed. ● Begin staged packing of nonessential materials. ● Continue engagement and planning to repurpose buildings for closures.
June – August 2027	● Complete phased moves. ● Complete receiving-school improvements. ● Install technology and set up classrooms. ● Complete transportation preparations: routing. ● Conduct staff onboarding. ● Continue community connections events. ● Complete readiness reviews before students arrive.
Opening of school: Fall 2027	● Provide opening-day and early-transition support. ● Monitor student services, transportation, enrollment, and school climate. ● Respond to emerging needs. ● Complete remaining building closeout activities.
Ongoing and subsequent implementation years	● Continue engagement, monitoring, public reporting, and evaluation. ● Refine supports. ● Apply lessons to later transitions for 2028-2029 ● Continue engagement, planning, and actions to repurpose closed buildings.

Next Steps

The Superintendent's Recommendation is the next phase of a public review period. After the formal presentation to the Board on November 17, students, families, staff and community members can learn more and share feedback before the Board votes on December 15. There will be listening sessions at Franklin High School on November 19 and Grant High School on December 3, each with a student listening hour followed by a

public session. There will also be an opportunity for communities to learn more about the recommendation on Saturday November 21 at McDaniel High School. The Board will discuss the recommendation at its November 17 and December 1 meetings, and the Teaching, Learning and Equity Committee will review it on December 2.

We continue to plan and coordinate additional engagements prior to the Board vote. Please check the Rightsize webpage for updated information.

Tue, Nov 17	Superintendent's recommendation	Board meeting
Thu, Nov 19	Listening sessions: Franklin HS	Student Listening Hour, 5–6 PM (also virtual) Public Listening Session, 6–8 PM
Sat, Nov 21	Understanding the Recommendation: McDaniel HS	Community reviews the Superintendent's recommendation; 1 PM - 3 PM
Tue, Dec 1	Board of Education meeting	Review and consider the recommendation
Wed, Dec 2	Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee review	Review and consider the recommendation
Thu, Dec 3	Listening sessions: Grant HS	Student Listening Hour, 5–6 PM Public Listening Session, 6–8 PM
Tue, Dec 15	Board of Education meeting	Rightsizing vote
After Dec 15	Transition and implementation	Pending outcome of Board vote

While the Board considers the recommendation, district staff are planning ahead for the transition and implementation, and those plans will stay flexible so they can be adjusted to match the Board's final decision. That way, PPS can act quickly once the Board votes, with a comprehensive transition guide, supports, and resources for students, families and staff.

Attachments

Attachments

A. Resolution 7307 May 26, 2026
B. Resolution 7296 April 14, 2026
C. School Closure Reports
D. School Impact Summaries
E. Equity Audit Evaluation of PPS Southeast Enrollment and Program Balancing Initiative
F. Methodology: How the rightsizing scenarios were developed and evaluated
G. Slide Deck 11.17.26 BOE
H. 2.10.010-P Racial Educational Equity Policy
I. 4.10.045-P Student Assignment to Neighborhood Schools
J. 4.10.051-P Student Enrollment and Transfers
K. 6.10.022-P Educational Options Policy
L. 8.70.042-P Dedicated Reserve for Income from Disposition of Surplus Real Properties
M. 8.70.040-P Preservation, Maintenance, and Disposition of District Real Property
N. Lottery Demand Report
O. Sample Transportation Routes
P. Rightsizing Key Performance Indicators
Q. 6.10.030-P School Initiation and Closure Policy
R. Communications Tactics